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Editor's Note

Communication is an essential aspect of life, a necessity without which we cannot live. There are two parts to communication - speaking and listening. People yearn to speak. We are oftentimes seized by an overwhelming desire to make ourselves known to others, to reveal the abundant thoughts and rich feelings of our inner selves to the rest of the world, and to be empathized with or sympathized. At the same time, people yearn to listen. We want to listen to the tales of others, to pay heed to the lessons their stories teach us, and to empathize with and sympathize them. Just a mere ten minute surf through Facebook is sufficient to clearly demonstrate this. Scrolling down through a foliage of status updates, one cannot but notice that this is an agora where people share their thoughts and recollections and offer insights into those of acquaintances, or unveil their grievances and offer words of sympathy and consolation. It is a plaza where the desires of people to communicate are fulfilled.

It is fortunate that human beings have a continual desire for communication, for its value is immense. Communication is progress. It is the stimulus that underlies in the history of human development. Through words experiences were transferred. Through written mediums knowledge was passed down. Through abstract expressions unique views and perspectives of the world were voiced in the form of art. Through communication the agglomerate wisdom of a generation was handed down to the next, accumulating over time to this present day. Through communication, it has gone from a simple wooden wheel on a medieval chariot to a saw-toothed wheel in a steam engine to a tiny component of a space shuttle.

Consequently, the blockage of communication is one of the greatest vices and oppressions that can be imposed on people. The absence of sufficient communication leads to misunderstandings, misunderstandings lead to quarrels, and quarrels lead to deteriorations of relationships ranging from interpersonal to international. When relationships start to fall apart, cooperative development is hindered and progress deterred. So people fight for free speech.

To truly appreciate the value of communication, the understanding of communication must inevitably precede - the mediums, the advantages, the setbacks, and limitations in usage. In this issue of *Minjok Herald*, we discuss in depth communication in Korean Minjok Leadership Academy. We look into language, the most fundamental form of communication. We look into digital technologies and devices that enable communication at the most cutting-edge level. And we look into art, the mode of communication that borders on the aesthetic and the philosophical. We bring to you the distinctive characteristics of these forms of communication in our school.

Minjok Herald itself is a means of communication between the students, a fact we pride ourselves on. In making this issue, we too have strived hard to make possible uninhibited communication in bringing to the students the ideas of the school, and vice versa. But more importantly, this time we hope to deliver and to get across this message.

Listen. Speak.

Communicate.

Sincerely,

Lee Hwee-Jun

Editor-in-Chief

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New Roles for New Teachers

A new semester has started. Waves of small and big changes have surged the school. The students changed: fourteenth wavers graduated, and thus, left the school officially, whereas seventeenth wavers became the official members of Korean Minjok Leadership Academy (KMLA) Family. The teachers changed, too: several teachers left the school, and in return, new teachers joined the school. Within the school, remaining teachers also experienced change: they were given new occupations.

There are a number of work KMLA teachers need to do, apart from the basic duty of teaching the students. Most of the KMLA teachers belong to various departments, representatively Department of Student Affairs, Department of Educational Counsel, Department of Academic Affairs, and Department of Educational Planning. Teachers in Department of Student Affairs handle students' daily life; they pay attention to articles regarding penalty points, including dress codes and insolent attitude toward teachers. Teachers in Department of Educational Counsel consult students about their school lives, such as relationships among friends, and their pre-college plans. Department of Academic Affairs manages academic curriculums, students' grades, etc. Department of Educational Planning concerns issues such as school development, strategic planning, school promotion, and international affairs.

Among the teachers, some are appointed as the Chiefs of each department; the Chiefs handle everything that has to do with the department. Every few years, the Chiefs are replaced to other members within the department. Not only the Chiefs, but also the members sometimes change.

The last replacement took place on 2009. Three years have passed, and the teachers were assigned to new occupations. Chiefs of departments were all replaced: Department of Student Affairs, from Mr. Seong Heon-Je to Mr. Kim Myung-Soon; Department of Educational Counsel, from Mr. Jun Soo-In to Mrs. Park Haye-Seon; Department of Academic Affairs, from Mr. Jeon Dong-Seong to Mr. Park Hyong-Jong; Department of Educational Planning, from Mr. Kim Jung-Moo to Mr. Choi Kwan-Young. Some teachers transferred to new Departments: Mrs. In Su-Yeon moved from Department of Academic Affairs to Department of Student Affairs. Mrs. Chun Hyun-Ku, who didn't belong to any Department, newly joined Department of Student Affairs, too.

To some students who had not known the school's policy of regular replacement, the news might be shocking. One sixteenth waver stated, "It was a surprise to hear that the school reallocates teachers to different occupations. I thought the teachers, especially the Chiefs of each Department, were "fixed" to their position, so that they can perform tasks professionally." It is possible, as the student mentioned, that the newly-assigned teachers might be less experienced than the former Chiefs. The new Chiefs will need time to adjust to their new positions. Still, there is no doubt that the new Chiefs would do their best to perform as well as, maybe even better than, the former Chiefs. So let us give a great applause to the new Chiefs, and wish them best luck on their upcoming years.

Ye-ji Park
Junior Writer, 16th Wave

Change in Outdoor Regulation

"Hey, are you going out this weekend?"
"I think so. I hope my mom sends the text message on time..."

Every week, on days near the weekends, we can hear these conversations all over KMLA. Just as it is important to use the self-study period efficiently, it is very crucial to use weekends wisely in KMLA. Some students prefer to remain in school, but many other students tend to go back home during the weekends to refresh and reenergize. However, since KMLA is a boarding school, students can't leave the school during weekends without notifying the dormitory parents. KMLA is enforcing this notification rule with an "outdoor regulation," giving penalty points to anyone who leaves school without permission.

Until last year, it was quite easy to follow the outdoor regulation. Students just had to go in KMLA webpage and check a box to inform that they'll not be in school during the weekends. However, starting this year, the registering process changed into a new form. Now, the students have to notify their parents first and the parents have to inform the students' advisors about not being at school during the weekends. The change was made to prevent students from lying that they will visit home and go elsewhere with friends. Even though the change was made for good reasons, there are considerable complaints.

Most complaints are about the robbing of freedom from the students. One student said "The new process is not as troublesome as I thought it would be. Still, I feel bad about losing our freedom concerning outdoor regulation." Also, there are complaints that outdoor regulation became more tiresome. This type of dissatisfaction is especially high from the students with foreign advisor teachers. "It is difficult for our parents to contact our advisors since foreign advisors don't understand Korean and our parents don't speak English. Furthermore, there is some pressure to be formal and polite to the teachers, which makes the procedure tiresome." On the other hand, students who agree with the change say differently. They say that it was students' responsibility in the first place to keep the promise with the school. Outdoor regulation is a promise between students and school that they will go home or to formal events with their parents knowing. Unfortunately, students broke the mutual promise by going somewhere else without notifying their parents. Students who approve the change say that it's our fault in failing to manage our freedom. In addition, students who agree with the change say that the difficulties concerning foreign advisors can be overcome by simplifying the "advisor notifying" process by using e-mails or text messages to convey the message.

Is this change good? Or is it bad? It is not sure yet. Until now, not much trouble has occurred but it is clear that the school has lost its trust on the students and lessened us of our freedom. We will have to wait a little longer and see how the consequences concerning new outdoor regulation come out. However, it is crystal clear that if we want to prevent any other "loss of freedom," we have to put our efforts into retaining the school's trust in us.

Yoo Joon-Seung
Junior Writer, 16th Wave

Korean Young Physicists' Tournament

From February 8th to 11th, KMLA's only physics club, *Hye-um-nah-rae* participated in the famous Korean Young Physicists' Tournament (KYPT). The team's five 15th wave members, Suh Hyung-Ju , Kim Do-Yeong, Lee Sung-Chul, Kim Seung-Chan, and Kang Dong-Yeong, proudly brought the first prize to the school. This achievement qualified them to compete for positions in Team Korea for the International Young Physicists' Tournament (IYPT). It is not unusual for KMLA to achieve such a feat in KYPT. In fact, four of the five representatives for the IYPT were KMLA 14th wavers last year. It is now very well known among high schools that *Hye-um-nah-rae* has always been dominant in the tournament. Such a respected name can be attributed to both talents and efforts of the members.

The members of *Hye-um-nah-rae* are selected in the first semester of the 11th grade through rigorous testing, which includes A 100-minute written test and a self-prepared presentation on a topic of one's own choice. All tests are supervised by the coach, Dr. Kim Yeon-Soo. As many could guess, a position in the club is very sought after, and therefore many students who have an interest in physics apply for the club. However, the positions are limited; all applicants perfect themselves in preparation for the selection, but only the top five applicants are allowed to take part in the *Hye-um-nah-rae* legacy. The freshly selected 16th wavers are Kang Min-Woo, Kang Min-Gyu, Yu Jun-Seung, Shim So-Ho, and Min Ji-Sun.

However, with great honor comes great responsibility. The new members of the *Hye-um-nah-rae* still face strict training with Dr. Kim. During the next winter break, they will have to stay at school for 4 weeks and work on in-depth physics topics. They will read about great theorists, solve complex problems, and perform difficult experiments. In addition, in order to accomplish not only education on physics but also on national identity, they are required to read a book named "Korean History in a Spiritual Perspective" and participate in debate every day on Korean history.

As the new members of the physics club are starting their preparation for next year, 15th wave members are also still preparing to get the tickets for the international tournament. As proud members of KMLA Family, we should encourage the members to cheer up and do their best to bring about another glorious result from national and international competition. *Minjok Herald* hopes to write another article regarding the great accomplishments of *Hye-um-nah-rae* members.

Lee Eun-Do
Junior Writer, 16th Wave

TIME at KMLA

Hidden Hours, After School Programs

KMLA leaves much space for the students to fill up the time on their own. Individual Research time and self-study time can be used distinctively upon each individual. Yet, not as well-recognized as the other two above, after school classes can also be utilized by the student body to hone their personal development and to boost academic abilities.

After school classes can serve as supplementary lessons for regular courses. Besides that, these classes open the door to extracurricular activities that students are very much devoted to. The programs do not have to be academic-related, but can be any kind of class that can fulfill students' personal interests which cannot be satisfied in the limited school environment such as absence of particular instructors or time being of school teachers. Hence, students may invite instructors outside from the school-regardless of fields-who are able and willing to teach the fields that students feel passionate about.

In the second semester of 2011, there were a few after school programs offered: physics supplementary classes, economics contest preparation courses, cheerleading, *hae-geum* class, and so on. One of the 16th wavers, who takes physics supplementary class, willingly delivers the effectiveness of the system.

"Physics is a hard science field when one is exposed to it for the first time and that was my case in the first semester of freshmen year. So, I decided to take the after school program provided by Mr. Jeon Dong-Seong and my grades soared up in the mid-term of the second semester through extra time I spent on learning the subject."

Also, the very first cheerleaders of KMLA made the best use of after school programs to bloom their talents and aptitudes. The instructor had been invited from Seoul since the school did not have the suitable one for systemized cheerleading education. Before the after school program was installed, basic knowledge about cheerleading equipments or the performance skills could only be obtained via Internet sources. With the support of the after school program, the KMLA cheerleader team has grown infinitely compared to the beginning when it was full of confusion and disarrangement.

Certainly, after school classes are not thoroughly established that some students feel reluctant to register for them. Students are unwilling to spend their precious self-study times on after school courses since their effectiveness has not been fully verified. The uncertainty usually arises from less motivation of teachers and students themselves, short duration of the classes, and complexity of establishing a course by students on their own. These problems should be solved in order to enhance the hidden hours of this very school.

Especially, starting from this year, students only receive four periods of Individual Research times during the day-which used to be six periods last year- because the regular classes are reduced to five days a week. So, more teachers are considering after school hours to substitute the IR time that has diminished. This means that the teachers and students will have to seek a way to systemize the after school programs and effectively spend the given time.

Albeit, some self-study time has to be spent on after school programs and students themselves might have to do a cumbersome job registering for the programs just like they do for the regular courses or IR class. Yet it is just a furtherance of self-sufficient life in KMLA. It is the time for KMLA-ians to actively participate in after school classes and diversify the programs through incessant concerns and student participations.

Kim Hyun-Jee
Junior Writer, 16th Wave

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Self-Study Period of KMLA

All freshmen, when they first enter KMLA, worry about their grades. They ask seniors for help, and receive the same answer: "Study during self-study period, and you'll be fine." When the freshmen first hear this seemingly trite comment, they just laugh, not recognizing the importance of the four hours of self-study period. Then, as days pass by, and those days turn into weeks, they start to realize that the short comment they had heard at the beginning of the semester had held invaluable truth in it. *Minjok Herald* here introduces how KMLA students utilize their self-study period effectively.

For students planning to advance to Korean universities, self-study period is crucial for preparing quizzes. It is especially important for these students to study math, for the importance of math skills can never be overemphasized when getting into Korean universities. The sight of these students engrossed in their math studies can easily be seen in the self-study room on the eleventh floor. Besides math, students aiming for domestic universities also concentrate on improving their Korean and English skills during their self-study periods. In order to maximize the efficiency of one's self-study period, these students often search for the best places to study. While some students find their dorm rooms to be the most comfortable place to study, others prefer places like the cafeteria or the self-study room.

Students planning to go to foreign universities also find self-study period to be extremely important before quizzes and exams. They spend a lot of time preparing for Word Smart and Calculus quizzes, which are essential when striving for high scores on SAT and AP exams. Not only do they study for quizzes, but they also write journal assignments and prepare for presentations that are to come in the near future. Like those aiming for Korean universities, students with hopes for international ones also search for the best place to study.

Regardless of their fields, KMLA students often spend much of their self-study periods doing club activities and participating in group projects. Students frequently meet in the cafeteria and discuss about their literature project or make plans for the next edition of the student newspaper. Some practice debating about contemporary issues while others join regular basketball training in the gym. There are even those that conduct physics experiments in laboratories.

As shown above, self-study periods can be used effectively in various ways. However, there are many temptations that distract students from using their self-study periods most efficiently. The temptation to play games is stronger now that there are no parents to scold you, and the bed seems to lure you in after a nice hot meal. Despite all these temptations, KMLA students must use their self-study periods as wisely as possible.

Suh Yeon-Soo
Junior Writer, 16th Waver

Are You Wasting It?

When KMLA students are asked about when they put much effort in studying, they would answer that they study hard during class periods and self-study periods only. However, there is another important time students might ignore or belittle: free time. Free time seems petty and trivial, but has great unknown value.

Some might wonder how serious it is to manage free time effectively in their daily lives. Then, let's count the total free time in a single day. Twenty minutes between breakfast and advisor time. Another twenty minutes between lunch and fifth period. To add, there is another big chunk of fifty minutes between dinner and first self-study period. Then, after *honjeong*, we are given about almost twenty minutes before second self-study period. Is this all? No. If we count all the precious minutes spent on road and breaks between classes, total sixty minutes are added a day. As a result, surprisingly, students end up with three hours of free time per day.

Three hours per day is a huge amount of time, considering that students have four hours of self-study period a day. But students seem quite unaware of it, since free time is separated into fragments. Some may argue that such in-between minutes are too short and ambiguous to do anything, and thus, it is easy to waste the free time. However, the total three hours of free time is too significant to pass by.

While most people are careless, or even unaware of these free few minutes, some KMLA students use free time effectively. They have customized free time according their life styles. Some memorize Word Smart vocabularies, while others write short essays during free time. Sleeping can also be a good choice to use free time effectively. Sixteenth waver Yang Bo-In said, "I usually take a short sleep after *honjeong*, because it helps me to be more focused during my self-study period." Taking naps in free time helps students to stay awake in classes with fresh mind and be more productive in the self-study periods.

Most students usually spend their remaining free time on the Internet. When they are frequently logging on to Facebook, enjoying online shopping, and even playing online games, their valuable free time just flies by. If the students are more aware of the significance of free time, three hours of valuable time per day will not be dissolved meaninglessly.

Sung Yoo-Sun
Junior Writer, 16th Waver

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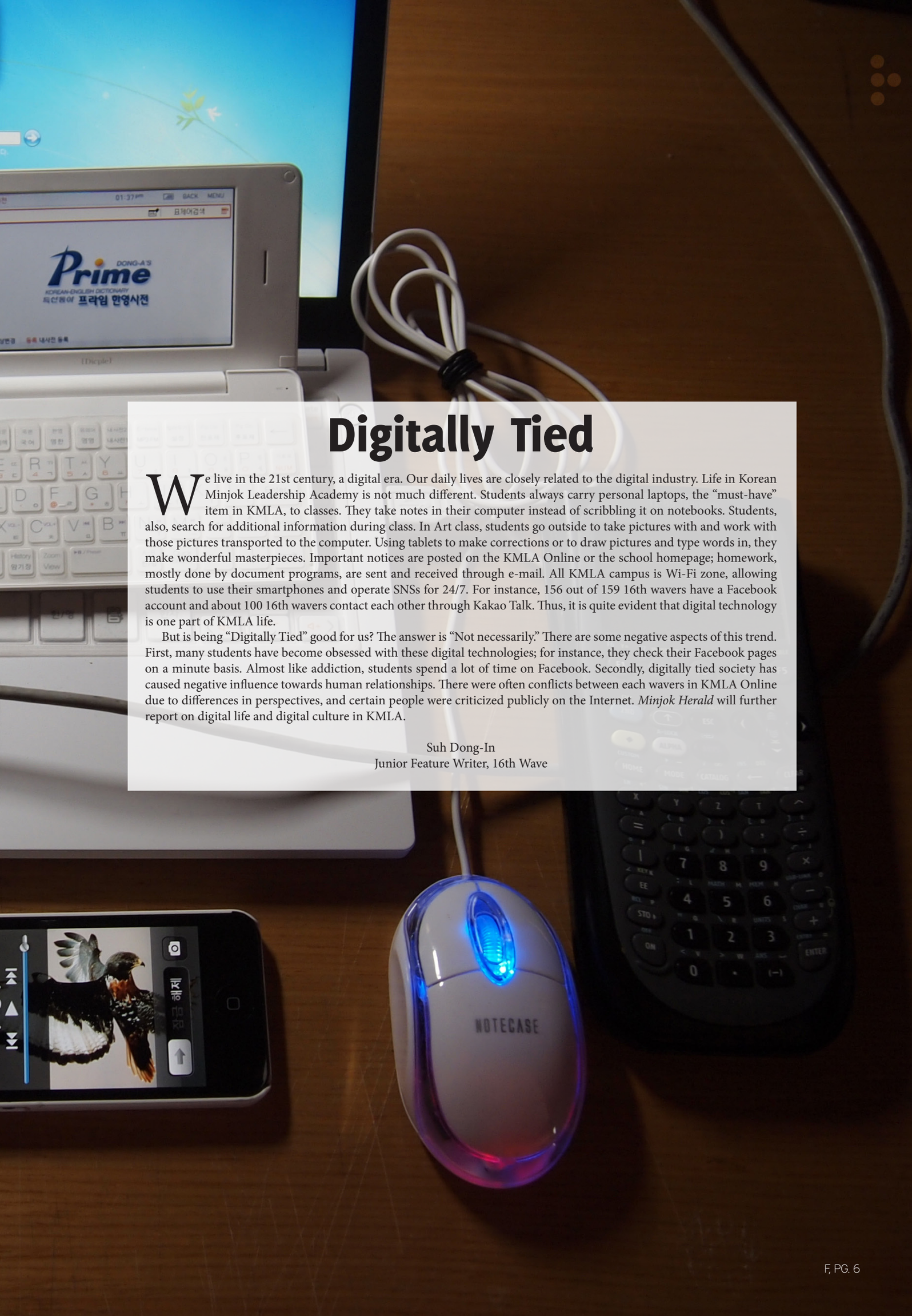

Digitally Tied

We live in the 21st century, a digital era. Our daily lives are closely related to the digital industry. Life in Korean Minjok Leadership Academy is not much different. Students always carry personal laptops, the "must-have" item in KMLA, to classes. They take notes in their computer instead of scribbling it on notebooks. Students, also, search for additional information during class. In Art class, students go outside to take pictures with and work with those pictures transported to the computer. Using tablets to make corrections or to draw pictures and type words in, they make wonderful masterpieces. Important notices are posted on the KMLA Online or the school homepage; homework, mostly done by document programs, are sent and received through e-mail. All KMLA campus is Wi-Fi zone, allowing students to use their smartphones and operate SNSs for 24/7. For instance, 156 out of 159 16th wavers have a Facebook account and about 100 16th wavers contact each other through Kakao Talk. Thus, it is quite evident that digital technology is one part of KMLA life.

But is being "Digitally Tied" good for us? The answer is "Not necessarily." There are some negative aspects of this trend. First, many students have become obsessed with these digital technologies; for instance, they check their Facebook pages on a minute basis. Almost like addiction, students spend a lot of time on Facebook. Secondly, digitally tied society has caused negative influence towards human relationships. There were often conflicts between each wavers in KMLA Online due to differences in perspectives, and certain people were criticized publicly on the Internet. *Minjok Herald* will further report on digital life and digital culture in KMLA.

Suh Dong-In
Junior Feature Writer, 16th Wave

Cellphone Regulation in KMLA?

It's the age of technology. As much as many might think that KMLA would be isolated from the trend of society due to its reclusive location, KMLA could not escape the sweeping wave of technological inventions. A particular device that secures a prominent place in KMLA students' lives is the smartphone. Its handy size, countless applications, and 3G Internet access have captured the interest of many students in KMLA, and the increased usage of cellular phones (commonly called cellphones) has caught the attention of many teachers.

KMLA is actually very lenient towards the usage of cellphones compared to other schools in Korea. Students are allowed to bring cellphones to class and use them freely during breaks. However, nowadays, with the introduction of the smartphone, regulations and punishments regarding cellular phones are sprouting. Cellphones, particularly smartphones, are perfect for furtive use: they are smaller than computer, yet allow more or less the same luxuries. Now, instead of opening their cumbersome laptops, students just hold their phone under the desk, slide to unlock, touch an icon, and then the Internet world is before their very eyes. Students do not have to worry about Wi-Fi connection either. The 3G Internet is accessible anywhere, anytime at all. Hence, students can easily text, play games, surf the Internet, and check SNSs just by using a hand-size device. Yes, it is very convenient, but this convenience and easy-access creates distractions. Now, it is just all too easy to do unrelated activities at a time when concentration and attention is required. Teachers are beginning to notice this trend.

Ms. Rene's response to students' usage of cellphones is to have students turn in their cellphones before class starts. During AP Biology class, she announced that she is tired of having students playing with cellphones in her class, so she will give out penalty points to those who do not turn in their phones. In addition, Mr. Seong Heon-Jae, who has been Chief of Department of Student Affairs last year, expressed his disappointment toward students using cellular phones in court. Thus, he forbade students from bringing cellphones to court. Mr. Kim Myung-Soon, this year's Chief of Department of Student Affairs, said he would carry on the policy. Even the dorm parent Mr. Kim Dae-Ki was angry at students playing cellphone games during *honjeong*. He stated that anyone who plays with their cellphone without paying attention to *honjeong* announcements would be penalized. As such, cellphone regulations are being enforced by teachers and thus the usage of cellphones is being limited.

Technology's purpose is to enhance humans' lives and to open opportunities and possibilities. However, misuse leads the school to take measures to limit cellphone usage. Spacious campus and dormitory life require students to have a means of communication. This means that we cannot afford to lose our cellphone usage rights. We should not take the generosity that KMLA provides students regarding cellphones for granted, but rather earn it.

Eun Ji-Lee
Junior Feature Writer, 16th Wave

A Lawful Violation...?

Jiyoung Lee
Staff Feature Writer, 15th wave

"Great leaders of the world."

According to the pledge KMLAians recite every Monday morning, leaders are what the school is trying to raise its students as. However, many KMLAians, sooner or later question whether the school is raising leaders in a proper way, especially in terms of supervising each student's academic pursuits within the dorm. The greatest question arises from flawed computer regulations: whether it can be manifested as the correct way to guide students along the path of becoming diligent, honest, and responsible leaders.

One of the greatest flaws accompanying Computer Violation is the objectiveness of the accusations. Although there are rules clearly stated in the student guidance book regarding Computer Violation, these rules are applied ambiguously, and there exist unspoken rules regarding computer usage - those which involve the subjective decisions of the dorm parent, which are often disputable as ill judgments. As stated in the student guide book, "Although watching appropriate movies and cartoons is allowed during weekends with no classes and during national holidays, it is not allowed during self-study time. If caught, the student will receive penalty points, as well as a confiscation of the computer for a month." Ironically, however, in the majority of cases for boys where computers were confiscated, students have not violated the rules stated above, but the unstated rules: using computer in their bed, and having their hands on the keyboard regardless of computer usage. For example, last year, 15th waver Lee Won-Hyuk was reported to have been sent to court because he had his hands on the keyboard – a clear 'potential' of having done other than academic activities with his computer. In another case, 15th waver Oh Seung-Min was said to have been caught while memorizing Word Smart, simply because his roommate had been playing Piccachu Volleyball. Yet, although these cases clearly do not violate the computer regulations laid out word for word in the student directory, those students sent to court for such reasons are not granted amnesty. Although cases will vary, it can in general be concluded that rather than helping to raise student's potentials as leaders by preventing unnecessary interruptions, Computer Violations serve rather as unwonted obstacles in the process of the student's academic pursuits, since without computers it is very hard to successfully manage huge workloads in KMLA.

There are, of course, reasons for Mr. Kim Dae-Ki's decisions. He says that requiring students to take their hands off from the keyboards is an inevitable measure. "I'm no god," he says, "so I can't see what the students are doing with their computers if the screens are not facing me. So I require that students take their hands off the keyboard, and if they are innocent, they should be able to do that." He also concedes that there may be innocent students who are punished, but explains that discriminating those few is difficult. Above all, he emphasizes that the regulations are there to keep immature students from making wrong choices.

And above all, when it comes down to downright facts, we cannot deny that many students who are caught for Computer Violations have clearly violated the codes stated in the student guidance book. Computer violation serves a significant purpose: to stop students from indiscriminate use of computers. Computer, of course, is needed to handle all the workloads in KMLA, but over usage of computer obviously distracts students from working. Without parents supervising them all the time, students must have regulation to abide by in order to maintain an ordinary life. However, given the cases above, there is no doubt that we need to consider the efficiency of this rule, and whether or not it is carried about in a way befitting the school's motives. A change to the words in the student guide book, or a word or two of negotiation with the dorm parent- both are democratic ways we students could contribute to making this law more suitable to the school's original goal, and ultimately to the student's needs.

Computer Addicted?

Eum Jung-Hoon
Staff Feature Writer, 15th Wave

Two years ago in KMLA, there were some grave cases of perpetual computer violators: one student even got caught five times in a row. Because the previous student guidance rules had dictated that if a student is caught once for Computer Violation, the computer is confiscated for a month, if caught twice, for two months, and, if caught three times, for three months, Mr. Seong Heon-Jae, last year's Chief of Department of Student Affairs, thought the measure too strict and came up with a new policy. Mr. Seong proclaimed that computers would be confiscated for one month only, but anyone who violates computer regulation more than three times would receive medical counseling on computer addiction. But the problem was that since the dorm parent had originally chosen to confiscate computers for one month only, to the students, the counseling had seemed to be added on to the punishment. Until now, two students, 15th waver Kang Dong-Ho and 16th waver Lee Eun-Do, became victims of this policy. Minjok Herald interviewed these two students for an insight into the effects of the new policy.

The charges on these two students were no different from the other students – except that they were caught three times. Also, interviewing the students, we could see that they were no different from any other male students of KMLA. "It's pretty well known that most students, boys especially, violate the computer regulation every day," said Lee. "It's just that they don't get caught. See, I'm only one of those unlucky, or rather naïve characters who always end up being in the wrong places in wrong times."

The medical care that the school required for these students was, by their experience, unnecessary. "None of the results of consultation were anywhere near dangerous," said Kang, "I had to spend 50,000 won and two hours in interviewing and surveying, but, as expected, I was found nowhere near addiction. Isn't the fact that we are enduring life at KMLA enough to prove that our normal lives are not being intruded by computer addiction?"

Indeed, our busy, hectic life at KMLA might be the biggest proof that we are not addicted to computers. Computer addiction, also known as Internet addiction disorder, is defined by a strong dependence on computer when offline and ignorance of any other social relations or activities other than those online. Also, those with internet addiction disorder tend to spend excessive, unnecessary time on the Internet. With all the quizzes and homework we have in KMLA, we can safely assume that anyone who endures this life in KMLA is not addicted to computer. "It's fine getting some penalty points and having your computer taken away. We can see that the school's trying to help us by these regulations," says Lee, "but see, sending students to get counseling may be overprotective. People go see advisors when they have psychological problems, and I'm sure I'm fine – I'm sure all KMLAians are fine. That's what the counselor said too. I'm not a serious computer addict, but the current school policy makes me look like one, and that can be a little hard to bear, especially because I don't even play games as much as others do."

Kang also raised questions on the viability of the current policy. "Three times of Computer Violations means three months of computer confiscation," said Kang, "I think that is pretty enough. Also, punishing the constant violators will not prevent the majority of the students, with essentially everyone playing games at one time or another, from playing computer games. It only prevents those who were unlucky enough to have gotten caught two times."

Lee Eun-Do and Kang Dong-Ho are not wild students who never do their homework and flunk every quiz. On the contrary, they have high academic accomplishments which befit a KMLA student. The school's policies would have been installed on good faith, but the students are not taking it as positively as intended.

Computer and Cellular Phone Regulations

Hankuk Academy of Foreign Studies (HAFS), Hana High School, Cheongshim International Academy (CIA), and finally, Korean Minjok Leadership Academy. What do these schools have in common? The answer is that students in these schools often feel homesick; it is mandatory for students to live in dormitories. Dormitories become homes for the students in these schools. However, big differences exist between a home and a dormitory. Students' everyday life is restrained because of roommates and school policies. They should have their roommates in consideration in any situation: whether a trivial action would cause a conflict or not. Self-study period is strictly restricted because the parent's absence might lead students out of control. *Minjok Herald* focused on the regulations on digital devices of the four schools mentioned above to find out both the special characteristics that our school have and the problems that we ought to solve.

In KMLA, our home sweet home, computer regulations are pretty severe. The school code mentions that students who use computers for non-academic purposes – with the exception of holidays and weekends – will receive five penalty points and their computers will be taken away for a month. For each violation, a month of grace period will be added. From last semester, a new regulation has been added: when one violates computer regulation for three or more times, the student will be enforced to take mental diagnosis or therapy. Such experience will be recorded on the student's report card in the form of absences. On the other hand, cellular phones are not strictly regulated. According to the policy, students are not able to use their cellular phones during class or self-study period. Using phones, students will get penalty points for self-study regulation. However, such a cellular phone regulation is not recognized by both students and school.

As for Hana High School, 12th grader Ma Ji-Won provided an interview of his school's situation. Hana has a rather strict policy. Students cannot even possess cellular phones in classrooms and self-study rooms. Phones are allowed in dormitories only. Additionally, students are banned from using their phones after midnight. Nevertheless, they use cellphones in classrooms and self-study rooms, and are usually not caught. If they do get caught unfortunately, they receive penalty points. Using cellular phones after midnight in dormitories is practically impossible to regulate. Laptops are not allowed in self-study rooms, classrooms, and dormitory; they are only allowed in hallways and libraries. Penalty points are given when laptops are not used for academic purposes, and it is confiscated for a week. Third time when students violate the rule, their parents are summoned to the school.

Jeong Won-Ki, a 11th grader in CSIA, said, "Teachers in CSIA do not regulate student's laptop usage. Students also, usually, do not rely on rigid laptop schedules; we rather follow flexible and self-imposed schedules. Games, comics, and movies are not allowed any time in school. Although students are strictly punished when caught, many enjoy their own pleasurable pastime in dorm rooms. Generally, coercion is not an applicable policy in our school, for we prefer freedom and self-regulation. I believe such philosophy is applied in our school policies. I think the system is more flawed than expected, but many students are satisfied with the current policy. When we are busted, we get nagged a little bit – sometimes the teacher takes our laptop – and that's all. No extreme punishments."

HAFS has the least severe regulation on both computers and cellular phones. Oh Chae-Ryung and Kim Hwi-Kyung, current 12th graders, said that students are barely caught for computer usage; however, when caught, they get penalty points. When the penalty points reach five, the students gather every Wednesday and get physical punishments, such as sit-ups. The school rule book mentions that students should use cellular phones only in dormitory. But in reality, possession is allowed. Nevertheless, except for the function of alarms, music listening, and time seeing, using cellular phone is forbidden.

The analyses of four schools actually show the similar culture of computers and cellular phones in dormitory schools. Above all, it is evident that a considerable portion of the rules rely on the students. There exist numerous loopholes, and it is left up to the students to realize that rules are not only made for the sake of the individual but also for the sake of the people around them. It is up to the students to respect others and adhere to these regulations.

Hwang Ye-Seul
Junior Feature Writer, 16th wave

COLUMNS

ESSAYS AND OPINIONS

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DREAM WIDE, TEENAGERS!

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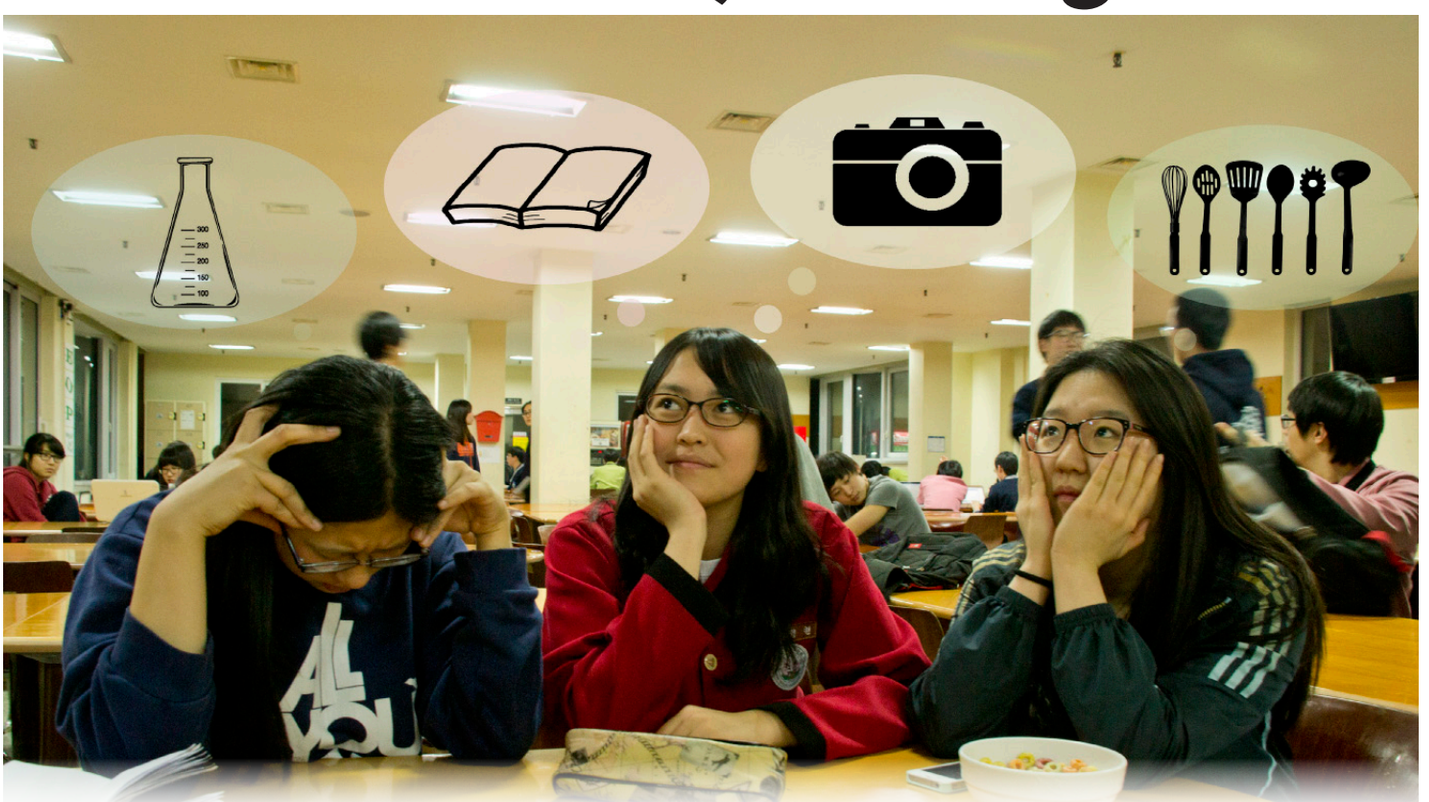
KNOWLEDGE THAT IS EMPTY

Dream Wide, Teenagers!



Every year, 3300 students graduate from medical school. Every year, 800 of them are left unemployed. Surprisingly, harsh competitions and weeding out of the unable is an omnipresent phenomenon. Throughout the Korean peninsula, natural selection, the survival of the socially strongest exists. These days success is not guaranteed even for an individual with specified and professional skills. Even for an individual who put their best effort on the work, the success is not guaranteed. Only a selected few, such as those who get almost the perfect score in KSAT, those who rank the first in the school, can have a slight chance to seize success.

The biggest problem lies within a stereotypical belief that endeavoring to get a socially stable and well rewarded career, such as becoming a doctor, lawyer, or CEO would simultaneously lead to comfortable and happy life. However, there is one great chasm in this thought: comfort and happiness cannot be gained just by one's occupation. This is well shown in the job satisfaction survey; doctors ranked second to the lowest (2.84 out of 5). Unfortunately, this misconception leads many growing teens to only dream of renowned jobs and to isolate themselves from what their hearts say.

Although this social trend of choosing jobs of high social recognition or high income is hard to reverse, it is not impossible. In changing this, the role of teenagers, the growing generation who will soon constitute the leading group of the Korean society, is extremely important. The rough competition, unhappiness, and fallen back people, will be modified only when teens alter their views and really follow their heart.

However, it is hard to figure out what one's heart wants when there is not enough information. It is like when one does not study, it is hard to grasp what one doesn't know. This is why it is essential to research different jobs of various fields. More specifically, reading biographies of historically renowned figure will definitely help a person to build up the general concept of whichever job the great names of biography has. Moreover, by reading their magnificent works and endless efforts they exerted, inspiration can arise and the unseen longing of the heart can now protrude.

Another way to solve the problem is beforehand experience. The inner conflicts, in most cases, are called forth when an imagination or expectation of oneself is different from the reality. This, in case of social works, further leads to the dissatisfaction towards one's occupation. The internship or having any kind of actual experience related to viable future job will come handy. It will both help to embody the future job and contribute in expanding one's capacity. It will also breakdown the might-have-existed illusions. Overall, it will assist one to feel the glimpse of merits and shortcoming from the job. During the internship, a person can also prepare for probable misery that can be created from unexpected defect within the vocation and can work even harder to overcome those.

One thing is sure -- there isn't any noble and the base among the jobs. The income, the hours of physical activity, the amount of work and other components of the job might seem to affect the high and low status of the existing jobs. However, the truth is that it is a human-being who views those components and who draws out the conclusion. If they, through the process of research and experiences in choosing the jobs, acquire conclusion that jobs are, in fact, more about individual preferences rather than settled hierarchy of pyramid, the present state of being, concentration in certain job and derogatory social view towards jobs of physical activities, will change. Moreover, if teens also follow their innermost desire, consider them in choosing jobs, succeed in different fields they have chosen, and prove that it is instead the passion inside a person, not the social cognition that determines the success, our society will definitely change. Take off the colored lenses and really see what your heart shouts. Remember, we are human-being. We have a power to resist, and we have an ability to overcome the natural selection inside the society. Dream wide, teenagers!

Jeon So-Yeon
Junior Columnist, 16th Wave

Knowledge That Is Empty

"You can't see me. But I can see you."

Through the receiver, he threatens Sua (Kim Ha-Neul) in a horrifying voice. He is a cold-blooded criminal: without even the slightest hesitation, he kidnaps drunken women, locks them up in his basement, and assaults them, resulting in their deaths. When he goes to his work, he performs back-alley abortions while listening to his favorite music. And he is a doctor.

The movie 'Blind', which was released last August, is a thriller about Sua, a blind person who came to give testimony for a crime scene. The truth about the crime case is slowly revealed as another witness, Ki Sub (Yoo Seung-Ho), appears. In turn, the criminal tries to harm those two witnesses in order to interrupt the crime investigation. Throughout the chase between them, the movie leads the audience to specifically pay attention to that man with the horrifying voice; more specifically, his job.

A doctor is one of the most admired occupations. It also brings both wealth and honor at once. In short, a doctor is one of those jobs that construct the so-called 'leadership of society.' Therefore, some of features of this job are the high affinity to advanced information, and people's complete trust. Here, what should be emphasized is that those features are all derived from the single fact that he is a doctor. Though the movie specifically gives an example of a doctor, this is about more: about all those jobs with such power. In this point of view, it is easy to conjecture how much influence, power, and impact these people have. Considering the power of these people, one statement becomes obvious: the world must deal crimes of the leaderships of society more strictly than they deal crimes of ordinary people.

Then, it is easy to explain why most of the hottest issues are the crimes of the leaderships of society, these days. The sexual assault committed by the teachers of Gwang-Ju In-Wha school and the other one by the students of Korea University College of Medicine captured such huge attention throughout the whole society. It was a shock for everyone that the teachers of a school for the deaf and the medical school students were criminals who have committed such horrible crimes. The public showed vehement reactions because the criminals were the people considered as reliable ones. Also, the fact that those criminals abused people's trust for committing and hiding their crimes provoked the public and pressed the button. The society was outraged at those people who abused their knowledge, those people with knowledge that is empty.

Knowledge that is empty pervades in our society. And it is resulted from the social climate. This society has taken a weird shape that makes us compete with everyone. The students of Korean society just cram knowledge into their head even prior to the establishment of upright personality and sociability. Their parents say, "You just sit there and study. I'll do everything else". All these things are contributing to 'knowledge that is empty'. Since the whole problem is caused by the social climate, there will be no sudden changes even if politicians pass a bill. The most important thing is to start from the individuals. Individuals should make efforts to establish upright personality, prior to accumulating knowledge. Of course, things like upright personality seem less significant than today's AP Biology quiz. However, as students of a school that insists on those less significant things, let us remind of the ambition we used to have when we first came to this school. Let us be those individuals who start the change.

Choi Ye-Rin
Junior Columnist, 16th Wave

Languages in

中國語
日本語
FRANCAIS
ESPANOL
Deutsch
한국어
日本語
中國語
FRANCAIS
ESPANOL
Deutsch
日本語
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日本語
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FRANCAIS
ESPANOL
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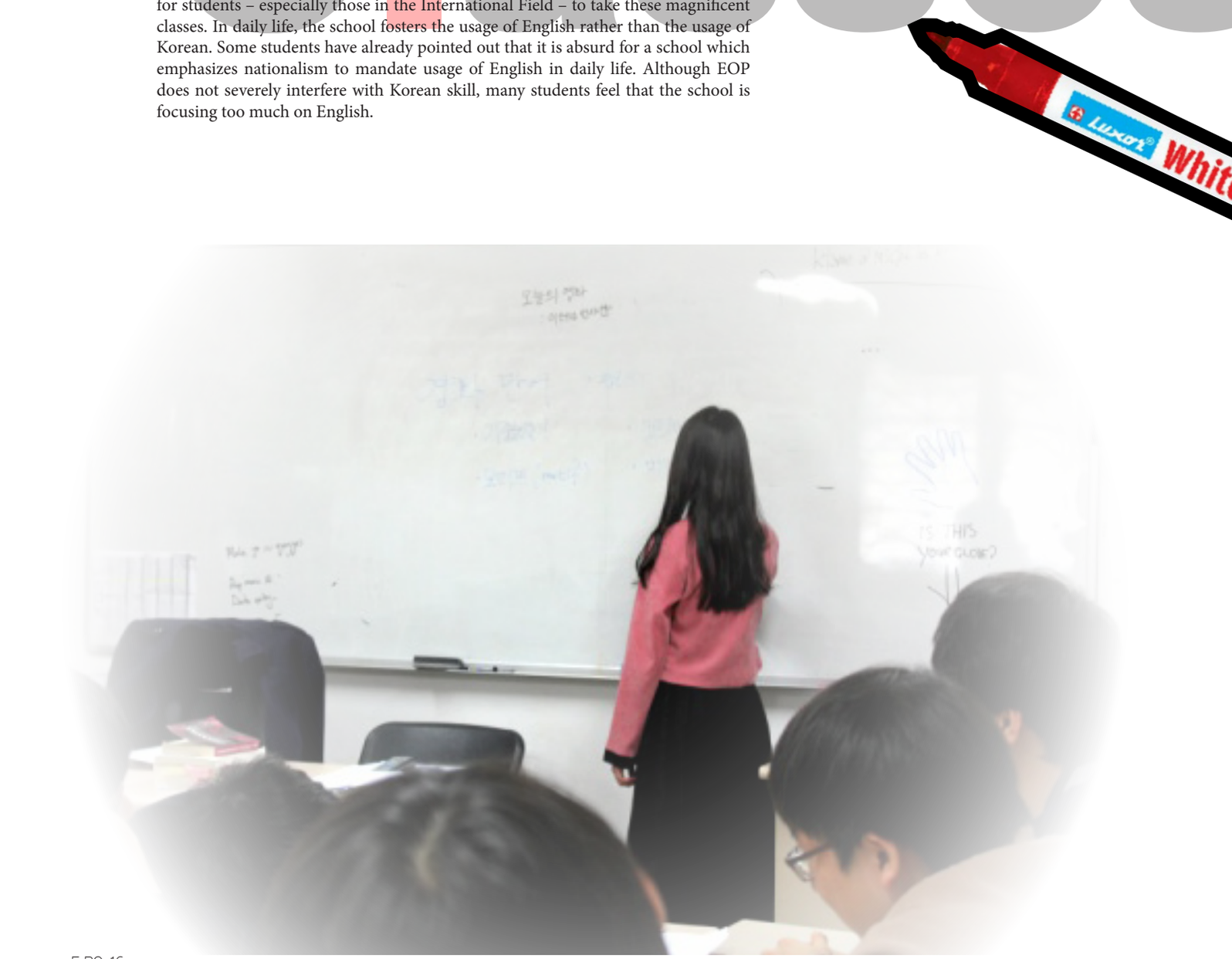
English, Korean classes

EOP and Korean

English Only Policy is one of the oldest traditions of Korean Minjok Leadership Academy. Every day from 8 o'clock in the morning to 6 o'clock in the evening, KMLA students are required to use English as if it is their first language. EOP enforces students to use English even when they blurt out slightest exclamations. However, students frequently ignore EOP unless student guidance teachers apply strict penalties for violators. Students keep using Korean behind the backs of members of the Department of English Only Policy and teachers.

However, students, though superficially inconsiderate about EOP, have a lingering pride back in their hearts that EOP is our proud tradition which we should carry on. According to a survey conducted in 2009 as to whether EOP should be abolished, a surprising majority of students agreed on sustaining EOP, even though the policy has not been kept until today. Many students consider EOP as one of the characteristics defining KMLA, and disagrees demolishing a tradition that penetrates the entire history of our school through a single census.

It is not only EOP, however, that KMLAians should be proud of; our advanced Korean classes are something to be proud of, too. However, there is not much chance for students – especially those in the International Field – to take these magnificent classes. In daily life, the school fosters the usage of English rather than the usage of Korean. Some students have already pointed out that it is absurd for a school which emphasizes nationalism to mandate usage of English in daily life. Although EOP does not severely interfere with Korean skill, many students feel that the school is focusing too much on English.



Korean Classes and Opinions

While Korean classes decrease from three hours per week to two hours per week, English classes, originally the same, double as International Field students become seniors. In a practical sense, the International Field's concentration on English courses seems reasonable: the students will have to study and settle in a society where English is the first language. Some of the 15th wavers in the International Field mentioned that they do not care about the school's current curriculum with weak Korean courses; they, instead, appreciate the loose Korean classes. However, many teachers point out the necessity to maintain at least the basic level of our mother tongue. Mr. Park Kwan-Su, who teaches 16th wavers Korean, addressed the importance of Korean in international society. Although it is not a major criterion for international college admissions, Korean is essential for those who plan to come back to Korea after graduation.

Korean classes held in KMLA can be divided into two types: the traditional type and the interactive type. The traditional type, which is a part of the Minjok Field students' curriculum, focuses on going through text books, discussing certain pieces of literature – such as novels, plays, poems, philosophical writings, fables, or ancient scripts – and writing a lot of essays. Students can broaden their knowledge on various types of literature. They also focus on advanced grammars and vocabulary. The interactive type, held for the International Field students, focuses only on presentation and composition. Each student gives a presentation about a certain topic and the others discuss and share their opinions about the topic. Students, then, express their thoughts through writing. By uploading the essays on the blog, they can share their thoughts with others.

Then, how do the students and teachers think about the Korean courses curriculum for the International Field students? Lee Seo-Hyun, 15th waver in the International Field, showed mixed feelings toward the current curriculum. "For the International Field students, Korean is not necessary," mentions Lee. "However, I wish that the International Field students can learn Korean much more systematically than now." On the other hand, Yoon Seong-Hun, another 15th waver in the International Field, showed enthusiasm toward interactive Korean classes. "Since essay writing is important to the International Field students, I believe that students should be given the chance to write a lot; then, the students will be able to learn effective ways to express their thoughts."

Teachers also show enthusiasm towards interactive Korean classes. Mr. Park views these curriculums optimistically. "Students are now able to effectively show their opinions and ideas through writings and debates," mentioned the teacher. Mr. Kim Jung-Hwan, another Korean teacher, also mentioned the importance of compositions in Korean classes. His classes for the International Field are focused on interaction – on making students participate, write, contemplate, and discuss.

A Gloomy but Bright Side

The reality, however, of the students who plan to study abroad is gloomy. For every wave, the average Korean test score among freshmen in mock KSAT decreased month after month. One student from the 15th wave mentioned that his 2010 Korean KSAT test scores decreased from 95 to 87. Several students from the 15th wave raised concerns about their blunting diction or sentence compositions. This is probably the result of difference in curriculums between the International Field and the Minjok Field. In the status quo, students in the International Field seldom learn Korean grammar or sentence composition. They focus on expressing creative ideas than on else.

Consequently, students in International Field tend to care less about Korean literature or Korean argumentative essays. Although International Field sophomores can speak eloquently about Shakespeare or George Orwell, they do not know much about Hwang Soon-Won or Lee Hyo-Seok. The basic knowledge about Korean literature built for 3 years in middle school diminishes slowly and steadily over the 3 yearS of English extensive course in KMLA. It is no wonder that the average Korean KSAT score of International Field students decreases month after month.

However, the blame may be on the nation's curriculum, not our school's curriculum. Korean students have to focus on college admissions. Therefore, the ability to choose better words, to write well-structured argumentative essays, and to adequately interpret articles and pieces of literature is overly stressed in Korean society. Mr. Park mentioned the deviating effect of college-oriented education in Korea. "Thanks to the rigid Korean high-school education, the International Field students in KMLA feel as if their Korean ability is decreasing, while in reality it has substantially improved."

Is this reality opportunity or failure? At least the students in the International Field have improved in expressing their original thoughts. However, they lack basic knowledge on what average high school students should know. We should remember that Korean is our mother tongue: to lose our native tongue is to lose our national identity and adherence to our nation. Through reading novels, listening to Korean news or TV documentaries, or writing journals or diaries, we should sustain our ability to express our thoughts and interpret others' thoughts in our mother tongue.

Park Sun-Woo
Staff Feature Writer, 15th Wave

What are the second foreign languages taught in KMLA? Most students would answer, "Spanish, French and Chinese!" with an exception of those who perceive Java as a language. It's true that KMLA, in its regular curriculum, offers courses on only these three languages. However, to those with will and motivation to learn, KMLA offers other foreign language courses. Most prominently, Mr. Alexander Ganse, the history teacher, taught German in the last summer session period. *Minjok Herald* interviewed Mr. Ganse on the German course he gives and what this language can mean to students.

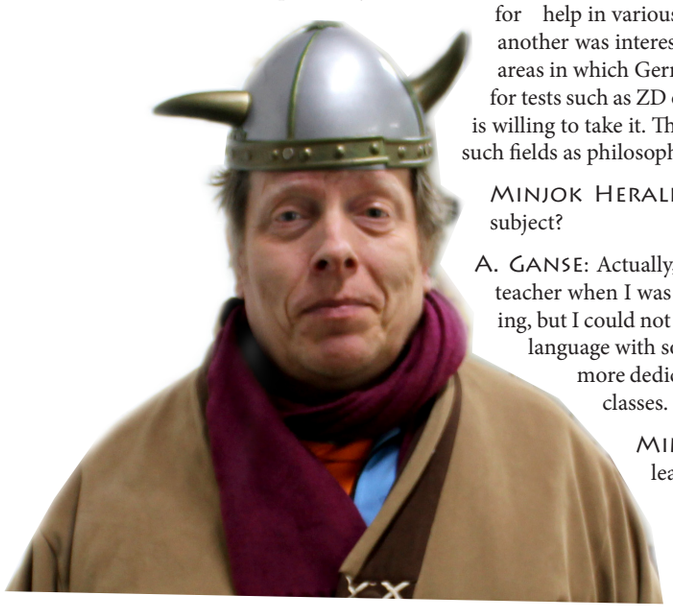
German

MINJOK HERALD: During which periods do you teach German and what do you usually teach?

ALEXANDER GANSE: Actually, as many students who took my class would know, I came to KMLA first as a German teacher. At the time, the male students were forced to learn German while the female students had to learn French. Nowadays, I teach history most of the time, but when dedicated students come and ask me for help, I do open classes for them. The recent classes were opened in summer session – a two-hour per day class everyday - but I didn't list them in the official summer session curriculum, since I did not wish to waste time on taking midterms and finals. With the motivations the students had, the class focused mostly on making functional readers – readers able to understand German textbooks – as fast as possible. The class was very self-oriented: students took to their own textbooks and delved in, asking only the words and grammar they could not comprehend on their own.

MINJOK HERALD: How can learning German benefit our students?

A.GANSE: Well, that's a question you should ask the students, not me. The class was student-motivated from the first. Students came to me asking for help in various areas: one student had lived in Germany and he did not want to forget German: another was interested in linguistics; the others were interested in classical music, philosophy, etc. – areas in which German is vital for thorough understanding of the field. I do not prepare the students for tests such as ZD or SAT German, though I do teach some tricks necessary for the test if the student is willing to take it. The German classes I offer are for educational purposes: understanding the texts in such fields as philosophy or classical music in its own language.

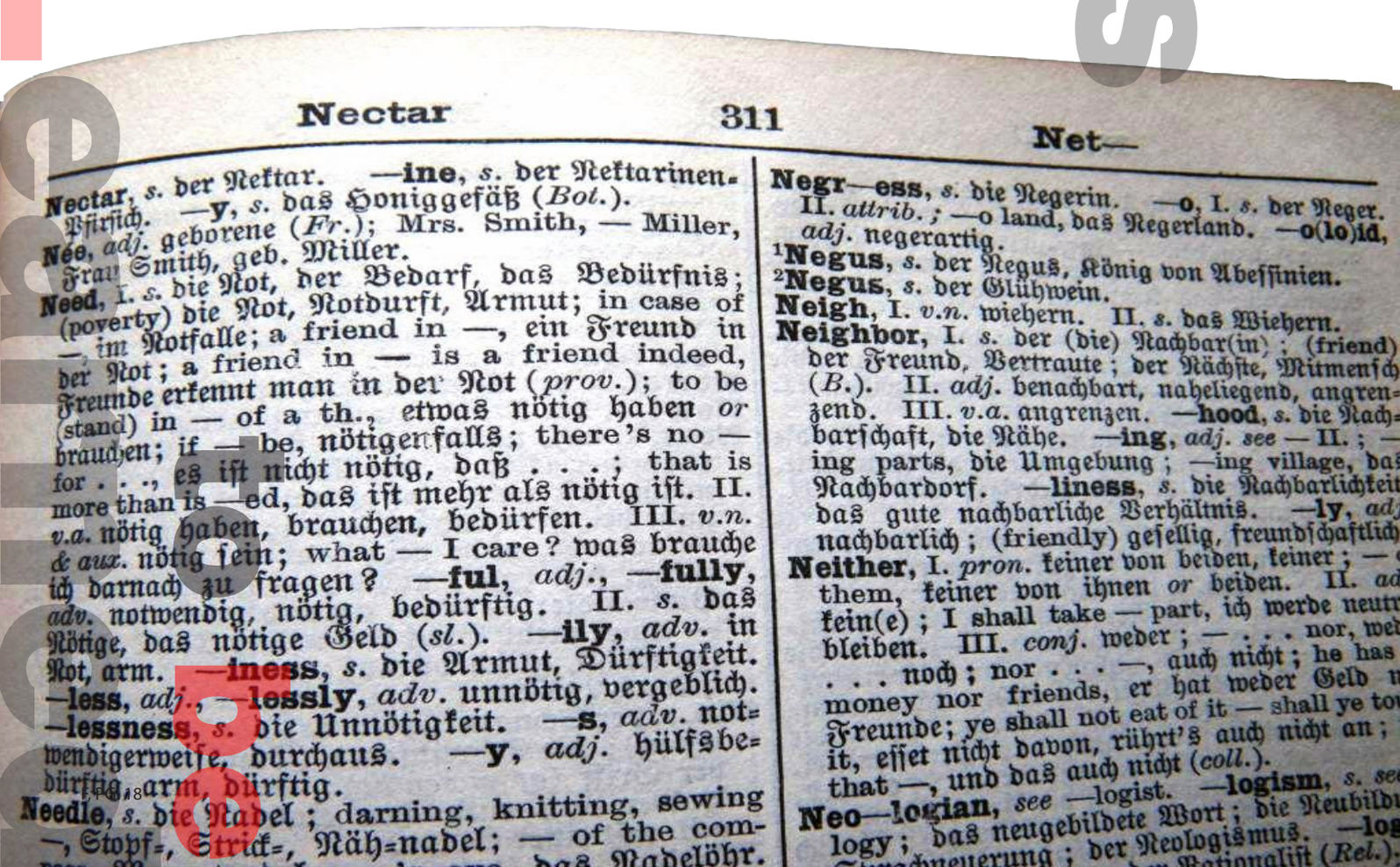


MINJOK HERALD: How do you feel about the current status of German in KMLA as a minor subject?

A. GANSE: Actually, I think it's an advantage. Frankly, I wasn't satisfied with my post as a German teacher when I was first hired here. I respect the current foreign language teachers' passion at teaching, but I could not feel satisfied with teaching two hours per week, which is not time enough to teach language with some practical use to all the students. The current classes, with fewer students with more dedication, are capable of bringing the students to a much higher level than the regular classes.

MINJOK HERALD: Do you have any other comments for the students wishing to learn German?

A.GANSE: If you wish to learn German, come as a group – the fewer the better – before summer session. My classes, actually, can change from German to Latin depending on the students' wants. Anyways, come as a group of dedicated students.


Nectar 311 Net—

Nectar, *s.* der Nektar. —**ine**, *s.* der Nektarinen-Pfirsich. —**y**, *s.* das Honiggefäß (*Bot.*).
Née, *adj.* geborene (*Fr.*); Mrs. Smith, — Miller, Frau Smith, geb. Miller.
Need, I. *s.* die Not, der Bedarf, das Bedürfnis; (poverty) die Not, Notdurft, Armut; in case of —, im Notfalle; a friend in —, ein Freund in der Not; a friend in — is a friend indeed, Freunde erkennt man in der Not (*prov.*); to be (stand) in — of a th., etwas nötig haben *or* brauchen; if — be, nötigenfalls; there's no — for . . ., es ist nicht nötig, daß . . .; that is more than is —ed, das ist mehr als nötig ist. II. *v.a.* nötig haben, brauchen, bedürfen. III. *v.n.* & *aux.* nötig sein; what — I care? was brauche ich darnach zu fragen? —**ful**, *adj.*, —**fully**, *adv.* notwendig, nötig, bedürftig. II. *s.* das Nötige, das nötige Geld (*sl.*). —**ily**, *adv.* in Not, arm. —**iness**, *s.* die Armut, Dürftigkeit. —**less**, *adj.*, —**lessly**, *adv.* unnötig, vergeblich. —**lessness**, *s.* die Unnötigkeit. —**s**, *adv.* notwendigerweise, durchaus. —**y**, *adj.* hülfsbedürftig, arm, dürftig.
Needle, *s.* die Nadel; darning, knitting, sewing —, Stopf-, Strick-, Näh-nadel; — of the com-

Negr—ess, *s.* die Negerin. —**o**, I. *s.* der Neger. II. *attrib.*; —o land, das Negerland. —**o(lo)id**, *adj.* negerartig.
[1]**Negus**, *s.* der Negus, König von Abessinien.
[2]**Negus**, *s.* der Glühwein.
Neigh, I. *v.n.* wiehern. II. *s.* das Wiehern.
Neighbor, I. *s.* der (die) Nachbar(in); (friend) der Freund, Vertraute; der Nächste, Mitmensch (*B.*). II. *adj.* benachbart, naheliegend, angrenzend. III. *v.a.* angrenzen. —**hood**, *s.* die Nachbarschaft, die Nähe. —**ing**, *adj. see* — II.; —ing parts, die Umgebung; —ing village, das Nachbardorf. —**liness**, *s.* die Nachbarlichkeit, das gute nachbarliche Verhältnis. —**ly**, *adj.* nachbarlich; (friendly) gesellig, freundschaftlich.
Neither, I. *pron.* keiner von beiden, keiner; — them, keiner von ihnen *or* beiden. II. *ad* kein(e); I shall take — part, ich werde neutr bleiben. III. *conj.* weder; — . . . nor, we . . . noch; nor . . . —, auch nicht; he has money nor friends, er hat weder Geld Freunde; ye shall not eat of it — shall ye to it, esset nicht davon, rührt's auch nicht an; that —, und das auch nicht (*coll.*).
Neo—logian, *see* —logist. —**logism**, *s.* logy; das neugebildete Wort; die Neubild —**logize**, *v.n.* Neuerungen machen; der Neologismus. —**log** —**nerer**, *s.* Neuerer; der Rationalist (*Rel.*).

Foreign Language

Learning How To Make Audiences Dazed With Their Mouths Open

Languages and Leadership

In the presidential election of 2008, distrust and resentment were at an all time high. However, President Obama mesmerized the crowd with a simple word "change". Whenever he faced hardships during his presidential campaign, he pacified the roaring crowd with magical power of speech. The story of President Obama shows how simple words can bring forth great changes. Let's look at why languages are required to foster leadership and how students in KMLA learn languages.

To begin with, language skill for leaders is important for the survival of corporations in global economy. Nowadays, multinational companies are looking for people who can communicate fluently with foreign counterparts; only companies able to break down language barriers will acquire new contracts and commercial opportunities in the global economy. In fact, many of the graduates of KMLA are receiving llove calls from American corporations. Several months ago, good news that a 10th waver was employed by the Bank of America made KMLAians proud.

Moreover, great speeches improve productivity of a group or organization. In bureaucracy, 'just tell them approach' hinders effective communication among the bureaucrats; however, often times, miscommunication have caused serious problems. On the other hand, if a leader has storytelling (language) ability, it becomes much easier to convey the exact views and visions of a corporation. Also, direct storytelling of a leader outweighs all other alternatives. For example, charts bemuse listeners and dialogues are just too laborious and slow. Mind-numbing cascades of numbers or daze-inducing PowerPoint slides won't have the same effects as direct storytelling of leaders. This reminds us of KMLA's student council election process. All candidates are required to give speeches that appeal to the students. Also, they have to write their manifestoes in an orderly manner to persuade and to give credits to the voters. Without coherent language ability, even the selecting process of the representatives of KMLAians is something unimaginable.

Finally, language ability of leaders enables the society to be united. Lists of abstract numbers and mere facts aren't effective at showing clear visions and people inevitably feel uncertainty about their future. However, storytelling of a leader changes dry and abstract numbers into compelling pictures of a leader's goals. Although visions of good businesses are mainly conveyed through the use of numbers, they should be approved on the basis of a story in order to unite people. Especially, when a certain corporation faces the task of persuading a group of managers or front-line staff in a large organization to get enthusiastic about a major change, storytelling is the only thing that works.

So, what does KMLA students do to improve their language abilities? First, they take regular sessions of language classes. Students are encouraged to participate actively in in-class discussions regarding literature and video clip. They learn how to express their opinions in a logical manner and how to interact with their audiences. English debate and public speech classes enable students to be confident in giving speeches just like leaders are.

Second, after-class activities foster the language ability of students. Students are required to finish piles of homework which includes writing essays, reading several pieces of writing, and watching news clips. Classes such as AP Language, for example, even allow students to enjoy greater challenges such as writing several synthesis essays. What's more, students individually participate in language related competitions such as English Debate competitions. They also take foreign language qualification tests such as DELF, DELE, and HSK.

Students in KMLA are certainly striving to get the most out of their language classes. In fact, many students have already acquired the necessary ability to become leaders. That is, they are learning how to make audiences roll in the isles, cry and inspire them. Incessant efforts of KMLA students are bringing them closer and closer to becoming respected global leaders who can change the world.

Kim Seung-Jun
Junior Feature Writer, 16th Wave

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Beyond Friendship

A boy rushes out the entrance of the dormitory, just to find that one of his shoes is missing. He looks around and finally finds it stuck in the corner of the shoe rack. He hurries down the stairs, but is caught late for school. Just as he arrives at the math class, he realizes that he has left his homework in his room along with his pencil case. He is punished for not handing in the homework on time, and has to ask several friends for a pencil. After the class, he finds out that there is a Literature quiz in the next period that he has not studied for. Depressed, he walks to his next class with his chin tightly tucked into his overcoat. He is wondering why all of this is happening to him when he spots someone in a crowd of students passing by. His face suddenly lights up, and with a big smile, he forgets all of the bad luck he had this morning, and waves shyly to a girl. She is the 'love of his life' he has met here in Korean Minjok Leadership Academy.

Like any other high school in the world, there are couples in KMLA. Most of them are kept secret to the teachers, since the school's policy is against 'unnecessary relationships between different genders except for educational purposes.' Indeed, just as teachers worry, being in a relationship distracts students from studying. It's not that those students lose their interests in studying; there just seems to be too many things to take care of: such as text messages you receive during the self-study period, your boyfriend's birthday during the finals - all of which makes it impossible for students to concentrate on their studies. A minor argument with each other could cost them several hours until they can finally concentrate on their homework.

Also, students in relationships might end up with a limited scope of friends. Since there is a person they love the most, they tend to care less for the others. The more time they spend with their beloved, the less time is left to spend with other friends. Fewer conversations lead to weaker bonds of sympathy, and if couples happen to break up, it will take the time to get used to the friends to whom they were negligent before.

However, viewing dating so negatively would be ignoring the numerous benefits it brings for the lovers. One of the most important advantages of having a relationship in school is the unique and diverse experiences the couples undergo together. They get a chance to learn and understand how to respect and care for a totally separate entity. Also, they will be provided a chance to think in the opposite gender's perspectives, which may be quite challenging but can be a helpful experience that would help them a lot in future interactions with different genders. They will experience emotions and situations which they would never feel when with same genders, which would help them mature. It may sound like quite a jump to refer dating in campus as a process in getting ready to be an adult and live in the society, but you have to admit: there sure seem to be points which only people in relationships can really understand.

Also, students could earn comfort and psychological stabilization from dating. Being in a relationship means that there is always a person to rely on when you are facing hardships and troubles. Especially in a school like KMLA, far away from home with waves of assignments and quizzes pushing in, having a person to depend on is much more important than in any other school, I believe. Apart from all the troubles, it would always be comforting to know that there is a person who would always understand you and be on your side no matter what.

There may be many boys whose hearts start drum-rolls when they see their lovers passing by and girls who stare at their phones until it buzzes to inform an incoming message from her boyfriend. Nobody can blame their pounding hearts and blushing cheeks. I believe it's up to the individuals' values and choices in deciding whether to have a relationship beyond friendship or not. Times spent with the beloved may mean more to some people than time spent wrestling with physics questions.

Dating in school isn't unfavorable, considering all the precious experiences that students would share with their dearest. However, one way to make it a little better is learning how to balance studies and relations with other friends along with the fascinating "relationships" they have with their lovers.

Just Friends

KMLA is widely known for its prestigious academics, its excellent students, the English Only Policy (EOP), and last but not least, its dating policies. KMLA discourages students from getting into a relationship with the opposite gender, and getting caught could result in expulsion. For those who do not attend our school, this policy and this punishment may seem a bit extreme. Being expelled from school due to natural affections one has for another seems to appall many people who are not familiar with the way this school operates, but to the KMLA family, many find the policy acceptable. The KMLA family, students and faculty alike, accept the dating policy, not only because it is traditional, but also because of its lax enforcement.

The dating policy seems to discourage relationships from forming, but in reality, it does not thoroughly prevent it. Many relationships between students, at first, are kept a secret from teachers, so that they can avoid the suspicious eyes of the faculty. In time, however, such relationships can reach the ears of faculty members of the school. Despite finding out, expulsion is almost never the outcome. Rather than condemning students, the school's objective in creating such severe punishment seems to be one of sending and emphasizing a clear message to the student body as well as the public: KMLA students should focus on their studies and extracurricular activities. This policy fosters a sense of time management, as it encourages students to use every minute of their time efficiently instead of being distracted. In essence, this policy is not much different than other rules such as "Computer Violation," which is another policy that promotes students to use time efficiently. The school's message is quite clear: Do not be distracted.

As the minute hand of a clock clicks towards every minute and every hour, that time spent never returns. In the business society, they say that "Time equals money," but in KMLA, it rather seems to be "Time equals GPA." Those hours spent text messaging, chatting, and spending time with their boyfriend or girlfriend will, in the end, only take away time from a student's daily life. In the first place, many students are very busy with their own extracurricular activities, so it is difficult for them to maintain their own academic scores. Thus, this will only be an additional burden to their "to-do" list, taking away sleep, which further will make students doze off during classes. Your every action has an effect and a consequence, and students need to realize this before making any wrong decisions. Living in KMLA for a little over a year now, I learned that the most vital part in maintaining one's academics is not studying until 3 or 4 in the morning, but the ability to utilize time efficiently throughout the day. As many KMLA students do seem to realize as well, engaging in any relation with the opposite gender will take away time, and the more available time one has, the more they can use their time wisely.

Furthermore, in a large campus such as KMLA where both males and females share the same dormitory building, it is easy for those in a relationship to cross a certain boundary. This is what the school is trying to prevent by implementing the dating policy. There are many advantages to having a dormitory in which female and male student share; one being that the mutual respect and feelings amongst peers of the opposite gender are earned. Thus, students can learn to sympathize with the opposite gender, even though they are not in a relationship. However, this advantage can soon turn into a disadvantage; the closer students of the opposite gender become, the more affection they can have for each other. Yet, in a one building dormitory school such as this, it grants couples the freedom to meet each other often and also the possibility to be emotionally intertwined to a point that it may cross a certain line of affection. The lax enforcement of the policy itself is trying to in fact prevent this. Although in very rare occasions, couples that are indeed caught crossing this line, they are nonetheless punished according to the policy – expulsion. As said before, this policy does not necessarily go against dating relationships, yet it does prevent couples of crossing the border of a safe relationship.

The school policy does in fact discourage relationships between different genders, but it does not serve to completely eradicate it. The KMLA campus grants students the opportunity to understand and think about what it feels to be in another person's shoes, a step towards maturity and becoming an adult. However, the school promotes only up to a relationship of mutual understanding, a relationship of friendship – no further. So next time, before stepping beyond the doorway of friendship, think again, and step back into the room.

Shorter School Weeks

A six day school week has been a tradition almost unique to Asia alone; most Western countries stand by the more common, five day school week. The tradition reflects Asia's emphasis on education and school. However, in Korea, starting this year, government policy dictated that all schools in Korea adopt the five day school week system. However, since the activities on the weekends have not been dictated by the policy, but left to the autonomy of schools, many schools have chosen to require their students to remain at school on Saturdays, and even Sundays, enrolling in mandatory self-study. KMLA has also chosen to require that students remain at school on Saturdays of odd number weeks until about noon.

There exist complaints that the school's mandatory self-study regulation contradict with the purposes of the five day school week and of self-study. The five day school week was originally enforced in order to provide students with more freedom, free from school and restraints. Yet mandatory self-study on Saturdays binds students to the school, thus directly contradicting with the intentions of the policy. Also, while self-study entails a connotation of voluntary and willing academic activity, currently the school demands that on these Saturdays when there are no activities such as school events and festivals, students gather at assigned places and study for approximately four hours under teacher guidance and surveillance. Therefore, in a sense, it is fallacious to call it a "self"-study - in fact, the phrase "mandatory self-study" may even be paradoxical.

Other concerns involve the effectiveness of the school's decision. On the Saturdays of odd number weekends, students are divided by grade and field, and put in one place under the guidance of few, sometimes one, teacher. The population which had previously been managed by several teachers is now controlled by one or two teachers - then it is no wonder that the teachers will not be able to keep the students under perfect control. The study atmosphere will be disrupted, and students who wish to study will not be able to concentrate fully, while at the same time, those who do not want to do so will also feel distracted.

The school's motivation behind the policy is well understood. It is a very plausible outcome that when students are allowed to go home every week on Friday night, the dependence on private tuition will increase - a phenomenon that the school cannot tolerate, as it contradicts with its educational ideology. Indeed, it is unadvisable for students to rely on private education and become dependent and passive learners by taking advantage of the five day school week. But in discouraging students from taking private education, the school is resorting to depriving students of their liberty. Instead, the school could trust on its students to adhere to its ideology and refrain from taking private education.

It is an irony that the government policy which respects the autonomy of schools, and the school's insistence on mandating the autonomy-respecting self-study is, in fact, deterring the liberty of students. The solution to the paradox is simple. Following the five day school week policy strictly - that is all there is to it.

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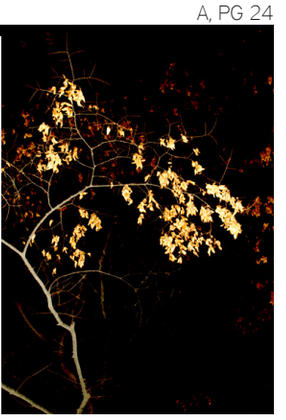

Art in KMLA:
TTL and Dohwaji

Korean Minjok Leadership Academy is known for its rigorous academics, high college acceptance rates, and supposedly intelligent students. However, as much as the opportunities in academics are abundant, those in the arts are limited. One may think that, being isolated in the mountains, students at KMLA may be inspired to create a collage of the beautiful Gangwondo landscape or create a musical composition based on the chirping of the birds. Even if such students exist, which I doubt, students at KMLA simply do not have the time to leisurely pursue their artistic talents. What KMLA does offer, however, are numerous clubs, in which students are able to pursue their passions in an organized and efficient manner. And perhaps because of the lack of opportunities to pursue their passions otherwise, students have fostered these clubs to an exceptional standard. Two of these clubs are the photography club Through the Lens (TTL) and the arts club *Dohwaji*.

Both TTL and *Dohwaji* offer artistic opportunities that would otherwise be very limited in KMLA. Although their areas of focus differ, both clubs are concerned with expressing and bonding through art by creating, critiquing, then publishing each others' artwork.

However, there are some key differences between the two clubs. And a meeting with the two club captains showed how it is essential to realize that these differences are very important. Especially for the 16th and 17th wave student, if one accidentally mistakes TTL for *Dohwaji* or vice versa, the two 15th wave captains claim that they will not stand still.

What I had expected to be an ordinary discussion about the two clubs became a cute argument between former TTL captain Lee Chang-Woo (15th wave) and *Dohwaji* captain Park Mi-So (15th wave). The interview started quietly as we discussed some similarities between TTL and *Dohwaji*. However, when asked for some key differences between the two clubs, Lee Chang-Woo excitedly mentioned "TTL is the best!" And so started the debate. From then on, the interview consisted of rebuttals and counterarguments between the two captains. As a 16th waver and furthermore as a Minjok Herald reporter, I had to stifle my laughter as two 15th wave sunbaes sat in front of me arguing in the most cutest and somewhat civilized manner possible.

And while the interview was extremely entertaining, it was informative as well.

During the interview, Lee Chang-Woo mentioned that one key difference between TTL and *Dohwaji* are their histories. TTL has been at KMLA since the 7th wave, and members of TTL continue to contact and learn from each other even after graduation. *Dohwaji*, on the other hand, is a very recent club that began from some students' desire for hand-drawn art. Opportunities for art are already very limited at KMLA, for even the arts classes we do have here are computerized. However, those for hand-drawn art, such as painting or drawing, are even more so. Therefore, Park Mi-So felt that students needed to get in touch with their more innate and humane artistic talents. And while Lee Chang-Woo was proud of TTL's long history, Park Mi-So was equally proud of *Dohwaji*'s short one. In her words, a deep history may perhaps be limiting since certain conventions from times past will continue to be followed. On the other hand, *Dohwaji* is able to continuously experiment with its artwork and structure.

Another key difference between the two clubs may be obvious: TTL focuses on photography and *Dohwaji* on art. Both captains agreed, perhaps for the first time, that there are certain differences between the two modes of art. For example, hand-drawn artwork requires planning and persistence while photography consists of a single moment. Park Mi-So then also mentioned that photography requires less talent, and we were back to our cute debate.

As much as the various quarrels during the interview prove how different TTL and *Dohwaji* may be, they also illustrate one characteristic both clubs share: passion. Debates arise when there are differing opinions, but only if these opinions are backed by passionate supporters. And so, TTL and *Dohwaji* become prime examples of the clubs that help KMLA student pursue their talents; talents that are unique and distinct, but united by a binding fervor.

Chung Yoo-Jin
Junior Writer, 16th wave

Minjok Herald: Film

I was about three years old the first time I went to the cinema. My mother took me and my sister to see Snow White and the Seven Dwarfs (1937), and the old hag evil queen frightened me so much that I hid behind the seat in front of me for the last 20 minutes of the movie. I didn't return to the cinema for another five years and then, at the Rex Cinema in Wilmslow, Greater Manchester, I saw a movie that would change my life: Star Wars (1977). Ever since then, I think it's fair to say that I have felt, even if only the slightest tremor, the same thrill at the dimming of the lights and the flicker from the projector of every movie I have been to see in a theatre.

As I've gotten older, my relationship to cinema has evolved from fantasy and fanaticism to screenwriting and a failed attempt at film school to criticism and teaching classes at KMLA. I rarely now seek out films solely for the need to escape the trials, insecurities, and banalities of my own world. I am still capable of allowing a film to paw and scratch at my emotions (as evidenced by my quiet weeping at the end of E.T. (1982) in my IR class on Steven Spielberg), but a movie has to offer more than an emotional treat and more than a surface narrative to really hold my attention. I don't really watch movies anymore; I interact with them. In fact, the best films demand this of their audiences. You can't just turn off your brain and have fun watching Kubrick's 2001: A Space Odyssey (1968). Why would you want to? Why would you want to do this with any movie? Pay attention; take your time; think. More often than not a film will reward you for this kind of viewing. The closing credits sequence of Scorsese's Taxi Driver (1976) is a great example of staying engaged right to the very end.

Of course, this is not easy to do. Film lives in a realm of passivity and relaxation; after all, the lights are off. Students are conditioned in school that reading is an activity and are told to read between the lines, but not so for film and seeing between the frames. The expectation of a passive viewer is a thing that allows movies to be entertaining, subversive, and potentially dangerous all at the same time. Avatar (2009) is certainly fun, but not many of the millions who bought tickets went to the theatre wanting a critique on Bush foreign policy, and fewer still realized they might have just been fed either another morsel in the acceptance of violence as pornography or a call for the militarization of the eco movement.

This is not just a problem of expectation and ideas; it is a problem of language. Most people, including myself, have little understanding of the complex grammar and vocabulary of film. How is an establishing shot different from a medium shot? What different information do they convey? What is rack focus? What's the 180° rule? What's the difference between diegetic and non-diegetic sound? The technical aspects of film are staggering enough let alone the application or the translation of that language. Do you need an understanding? No, but you should have an awareness that there is more on the screen than what is on the screen.

When I was eight years old and watching an impossibly enormous spaceship slide into view with its laser cannons firing, I had no concept of cinematography or editing or composition. I knew that I loved what was on that silver screen and I loved it enough to keep it with me, to learn from it, and to teach it. So, the next time you're at the cinema or watching a movie on your computer, be entertained, but also engage in the dialogue of film: respond to the questions the movie is asking and demand answers to the questions you pose.

Neil Tweedie

OPINION

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Class Meetings – Because We Care

Every Monday at 8th period, all 10th and 11th graders are required to be in their advisors' offices for class meetings. There is roll call, the class representatives head the meeting according to the form, uploaded by the Legislative Branch every week and available on KMLA Online. After making announcements and collecting student opinions and votes, the class representatives fill and upload the form. A Legislative Branch member comes around for a second roll call, and the class meeting is officially over.

The meetings serve as a way of communication - through the class meetings, the Legislative Branch seeks to enhance understanding between the school and the students. Often, the job is more difficult than one might assume. The Legislative Branch must act as arbitrators between parties of different interests – students, teachers, administrators, different clubs and departments – and there are also times when certain issues continue to remain in the agenda for weeks. As a result, when the votes are tallied up by the members of the legislative council, the chief of the branch stays busy all week getting answers to students' questions from the school administrator and the dietician. The results of such queries are announced at the Assembly of Representatives on Sundays, and are also reflected in the form for the class meeting of the following week.

While excellent in their aim, and seemingly flawless in their process, class meetings are currently at a stalemate. The most visible – and relevant – problem is the lack of participation. Students often sleep or study instead of participating in the meetings, and some do not even stay in the classroom at all. Sometimes, entire classes go out of school to have dinner when they are supposed to be holding class meetings.

Why are students so unwilling to participate? Some complain that they cannot see how their opinions are being recognized, while others say that the response to student suggestions takes too long, making them impatient. Yet others are simply indifferent about the matters being discussed, unless it concerns them in the most direct sense – for example, many students actively discuss food-related topics but neglect issues such as the new minjok currency policy for the Minjok Festival.

All of these reasons are legitimate. For most school-related problems, active participation, instead of waiting for solutions to be conjured, might be the best –and perhaps only – solution. In the first semester of 2011, students could rely on the incentive system from causing the worst problems, since the vice class representatives went around and graded classes according to their enthusiasm and participation during class meetings. The incentive system, however, was repealed by majority in the second semester while the 12th Legislative Branch was in office. Since then, the only way for students to be actively involved in class meetings is by their own volition. That is, the ultimate key to reviving class meetings lies with the student body. Even if the 13th Legislative Branch decided to, for example, randomly pick a class and broadcast the class's student meeting live, or create a webpage on KMLA Online so that students can ask questions directly to the administrator, only student participation can make the policy work.

Of course, the Legislative Branch also carries a heavy burden. The 11th and 12th Legislative Branches both tried hard to boost students' enthusiasm for class meetings. However, many of the methods made little difference. Some students slept, some studied, some chose not to care, and only the remaining minority participated, no matter what the policy was. The Legislative Branch can no longer use an incentive system, but the student body would like the council to come up with a creative idea to promote active discussion. In addition, it would always be a win-win situation for the branch to address more issues involving student life and enhance the transparency of their decision-making process. Students will participate more actively in the class meetings when the issue directly concerns them, which will make sure that students get what they really want with issues that are the most relevant. In previous class meetings, students often lost interest in class meeting topics because they differed from the suggestions that students posted online. Also, the fact that some of the questions raised online were never answered was a cause of frustration as well. Addressing these issues to improve participation will not only benefit students but naturally benefit the student branch as well.

The class meeting is a long-held tradition at KMLA. It is up to the students to choose whether to utilize the meetings as the ultimate tool of student autonomy or leave them as they are, an hour for students to spend idly. The burden falls upon the Legislative Branch to come up with an effective solution, but in the end, the entire student body should participate to make the solution work. The difference between freedom and license is subtle; but once crossed, the gap is huge. That said, "letting it be" and opting for dinner instead of having a say in matters that concern us the most should not be an option. Let us keep this in mind, not because we must, but because we care.

Lee Sung-Jin
Junior Editorialist, 16th Wave

When to Open Our Eyes to the World

Traditionally in Korean Minjok Leadership Academy, the tenth-grade KMLAians used to go to either the United States or Europe for the two-week trip called the "Vision Trip." Then due to the novel swine-origin influenza, the fourteenth wavers went on the trip on their junior years. Since then, the timing for this trip has been changing almost every year, and for years, scheduling and choosing the appropriate time for the Vision Trip has been a headache for the school's administrative office. The problem is, every time period has defects, which is why the school frequently changes the vision trip schedule for every year. They are hoping that through a few tries, they might be able to find the most adequate timing.

For example, last year, the fifteenth wavers made use of their summer session during their junior year. However, the problem was that for the students who went to the U.S., most of the upperclassmen who went to college were away for the vacation. This prevented the students from hearing some hand-on experiences and personal insights that would have been extremely useful. In addition, since it was the vacation period, inexpensive plane tickets were hard to come by. Also, there were a few complaints from the students saying that the Vision Trip was too much of a distraction for juniors. The junior year is extremely important for students, especially in KMLA since the juniors take control of most of the school activities and at the same time, actively plan their future. There existed complaints that the high temperatures of summer made the trip uncomfortable.

So, taking these problems into account, the decision was made, to change the year in which the students would go on their Vision Trip. From this year on, the students will go on the trip in their freshman year, not their junior year. The basis of such a radical change is simple; students cannot take two weeks off their school term for a trip that they will likely think of as a vacation rather than a way to solidify their dreams for the future, with a truckload of exams to take care of.

As long as time is concerned, it certainly is better to go on the Vision Trip during the first year of high school, since tenth-graders are not as busy as eleventh-graders. But unfortunately, time is not everything that the administrative office has to be concerned of when it comes to considering the schedule for the Vision Trip. The problem is whether the trip can have as much a meaning for the freshmen, who have been in school for a considerably shorter time, as it would for the juniors. There has actually been previous concerns about this: the thirteenth wavers went on their vision trip when they were freshmen. However, the school soon abandoned the idea because as freshmen, the idea of college and applications wasn't realistic enough for them. The pressure of impending future was absent, so the students seemed to learn nothing out of the trip. Will it be different for the seventeenth wavers? Will the drastic change in the scheduling of the Vision Trip have as much a positive effect as it is supposed to?

To come up with an agreeable solution to this dilemma, the purpose of Vision Trip must be considered. Is it just a two-week vacation for students to take some rest from their rigorous schooldays? Or is it a chance for people to spend some time seeing blond-haired people they have never seen before? Even, is it a way to spend time wastefully with only when to waste the time being considered?

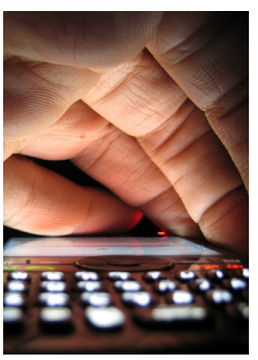
No. The point of Vision Trip, as the founder of KMLA, Mr. Choi Myeong-Jae, put it, is to help students establish their dreams for the global future more effectively and sturdily. Just because we are very busy in our second year at KMLA does not mean that the very point of Vision Trip should be sacrificed for a little slackening of the tight schedule of the eleventh-graders. As busy as we are, Vision Trip cannot be excused. Instead of complaining and rebelling against every school decision, we, as students, should rather be thankful for the opportunity to explore a different culture for two whole weeks. It would be better to accept the fact that no matter when we take this trip, there will always be faults and shortcomings. We have to remember that being a KMLAian involves more than improving our grades and going to college – it's about experiencing and making the most of what we have. For the freshmen and juniors who are waiting for the Vision Trip with anxious minds, best of hopes that you will take this experience to your fullest.

Jeong Yun-Jo
Junior Editorialist, 16th Wave

LITERARY CONTEST

MINJOK HERALD LITERARY CONTEST 2012

Living as a Cellphone-holic



It's just a phone, and I'm just a girl. Can I make it any more obvious? I want to deny that just like other teenagers, I have become a cellphone-holic; but obviously, I have. Although now tattered and worn at the edges, my one year old phone is still ivory-white in color with a sweet beige button at the bottom left. To my sadness, however, it recently got a small dent right in the middle of the screen.

You might be muttering to yourselves, "I don't want to know how your cellphone looks like!" but that was not my purpose. I was just surprised at how, in school, I tend to scrutinize my phone in detail, an activity that I never bothered to engage myself in at home. Also, while I carry my phone around with me at school, I usually don't even know where I put it at home. I wondered what this could mean.

Sending a text to mom and waiting for her "Fightings!" checking the time to see if it is close to lunch, and again, waiting for someone else's call… I watched myself carefully and wrote down in my head everything I did with my phone. I had to conclude that I was very easily distracted by it. Across the sound waves and electric signals of the cellphone, there are my parents, little brother, grandmother, and best friends. Bringing to me the voices of the people I love, this little gadget is a bridge that connects me to them.

Often, I would feel embarrassed when others would brag that they call their families less than once a month. I was worried that I might be called a coward who was wasting her time on nothing. But now, as I scroll down through my long list of phone numbers, every one of them bridges that I have made until now, I know for sure that I haven't wasted anything.

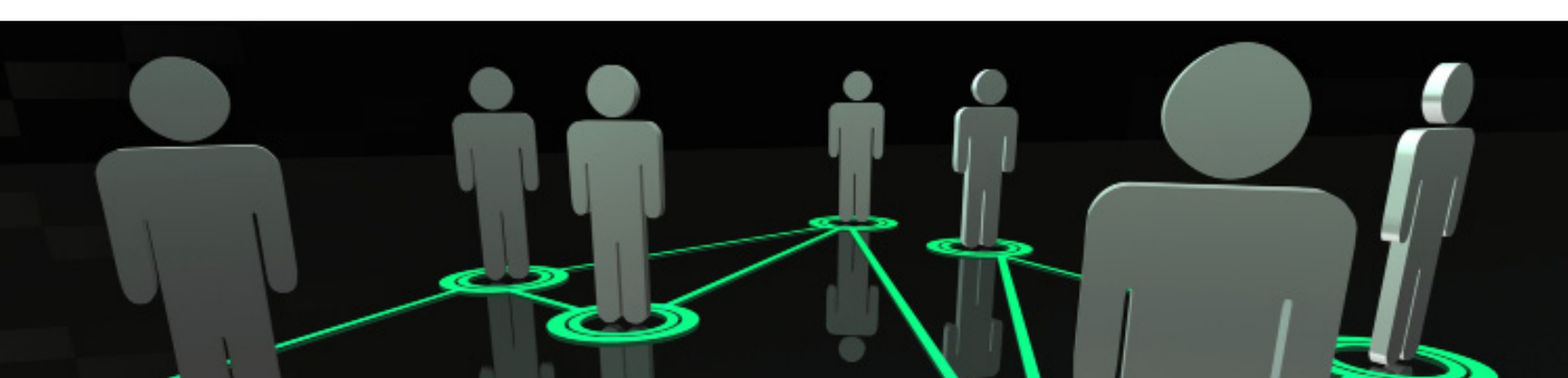
With my phone in hand, I can share what I see and feel right away with the people I want to share them with. On the day of the first snow, I would call my mom from the school dormitory to tell her how beautiful it is. In the first year of middle school, when a boy from my class hurt my feelings with harsh words and I was in my dorm room alone at night, I would listen to the voices of my family through the cellphone. The assurance of the fact that I was being loved came as voices from the speaker of my phone and gave me the energy to stand up. I, too, was able to be there with my little brother on the phone whenever he was distressed from the hardships of adolescence. The pictures of things that are precious to me such as the spongy birthday cake grandmother baked for me, the smiles of my best friends, and the pictures of home all give me rest in times of stress.

Cellphone is communication with the world. When I feel forlorn, as I often do in school, having many bridges that I can cross to meet my friends is even more valuable. I skim the list of people in my phone and I can see the life I have walked through. Of course, there are parts of my life so far away that I have lost contact with. Many of my elementary school friends I haven't even sent one text message in three years. There are even some names that I do not recognize.

I imagined my own name on the one of those people's own list. It may be ignored, or possibly, already erased from the list. With such destruction of a bridge, a whole world of interaction, care and friendship is lost - simply saying, one less shoulder to cry on. I remember that I, too, have deleted some peoples' numbers from my phone, unaware then that I was not only being foolish, but also mean.

There is a new group added to my list made recently that is still expanding; they are my KMLA friends, seniors, and teachers. As I look at the number of bridges growing, I promise to myself that I will do my best to strengthen them. My cellphone with all its bridges will no longer mean loneliness and separation, but a collection of bonds bound by long lasting relationships.

Lim Chae-Won,
First Place Winner, 17th Wave



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INTERVIEWS WITH TEACHERS

KMLA's New Family

February is a month of new start for KMLA family. New start always involves lofty ambitions, air of expectation, and bustling confusion, but most of all, new family members. This year, KMLA has welcomed five new teachers: Ms. Lee Won-Ki for Korean Language, Ms. Ji Hye-In for Morals and Philosophy, Mr. Jung Sang-Min for Korean History, Ms. Hur Ka-Hyun for Chinese Language, and Ms. Min So-Jeong for Biology. All of the new teachers are drawing the attention of both students and teachers, and *Minjok Herald* interviewed each one of them.

**The interviews were conducted in Korean and subsequently translated into English*

Interview with Ms. Lee Won-Ki

Minjok Herald: Can you briefly introduce yourself?

Ms. Lee Won-Ki: Hi, I was born and grown in Seoul, and I graduated from Seoul National University. I majored in Korean Language Education, and now I am studying for the master's degree. My hobby is, as well known, DJ-ing and exercising in health clubs. I think I'm good at presentations, though I am not sure if it can be said as a specialty. At university I worked as a public ambassador and a chairman of public relations of my school, and it helped me a lot with developing the habit of writing frequently. I am a person who really loves Korean but who had a hard time with mathematics in school.

MH: What brought you here to KMLA? Did your experience in KMLA as a student in the past affect your decision?

Ms. Lee: I really wanted to come to KMLA again, and I had so many things I hadn't done in my high school years here. Because of my poor health, I couldn't enjoy my high school life a lot. So I really wanted to enjoy my high school life once again, and that's what brought me here.

MH: We've heard that you often say natural science field students should be good at Korean, too. May we ask you why do you think so?

Ms. Lee: Since I teach natural science field students, every week I meet a lot of male students in my classroom. What I tell frequently to those students is, "If you can't read the poets' minds and written pieces, how are you going to read a woman's mind which is way more complicated?" Actually literature and language is connected to the life's most basic foundation. We use our language for our entire life, and our life, including relations between people around us, gets much different depending on how we use them.

MH: You've been in our school for about a month. What has been your impression?

Ms. Lee: Frankly I was worried a lot at the first time. When I was in school, I was a quiet and a little stubborn student, and so I was worried that everyone would be like me. But the eleventh graders turned out to be very warm-hearted and bright, and we get along nicely. Also the twelfth graders, as seniors of this school, also teach me a lot. I really love the nice, delicate aspects of students at KMLA!

Kim Sol
Junior Writer, 16th Wave

Interview with Ms. Ji Hye-In

Minjok Herald: Can you briefly introduce yourself?

Ms. Ji Hye-In: I am from Seoul, and I like swimming and playing the flute. I like something fresh and new, like eating pizza in this school. I majored in philosophy and ethics from Ewha Womans University. It took me six years to graduate because I had so many courses to complete. But instead, I got two teacher's certificates: philosophy and ethics. After graduating I went to Joongdong High School to teach Philosophy. I was there for three years, and now I am here.

MH: What brought you here to KMLA?

Ms. Ji: One of my co-workers in Joongdong High School named Ahn Gwang-bok, a famous writer who writes about philosophy, suggested me to apply for KMLA. Frankly, I didn't expect to get accepted to this school; I just applied. Another reason why I applied here was that I wanted to find a place where I can teach philosophy itself, not morals for the national college entrance exam. I wanted to teach philosophy through doing various activities.

MH: Why did you choose philosophy as your major?

Ms. Ji: When I was at high school, two of my friends died of accident. After that incident, I started to keep thinking where people come from and where they go after death. One of my other interests, writing essays, led me to think more about philosophy. So these things made me decide to study philosophy in the university. When I first told my decision to my parents, my mom was outraged. But my father was very positive about my decision. He told me the story of Carly Fiorina, a CEO who majored in history, and said that people who study humanities are the ones who should do things like business. Anyway, I am quite stubborn, so I just did what I wanted to do.

MH: How do you think of our school and the students so far?

Ms. Ji: The students here are very meticulous, and most of them seem to be perfectionists. Preparing for philosophy classes is surely a lot of work, because you really don't know how the discussion will go, and the teacher has to cover the all possible topics. It's such a hard job, but at the same time it's quite interesting, too.

There are some things that I feel hard about this school, though: students often compare me with Mr. Baek, the previous ethics teacher at

KMLA. I don't know much about him, and when students tell me how he did before me, I feel pressure. These days, however, I think I am getting more comfortable with those comparisons.

Kim Sol
Junior Writer, 16th Wave

Interview with Mr. Jung Sang-Min

Minjok Herald: Would you briefly introduce yourself and tell us how you are getting along in this school?

Mr. Jung Sang-Min: Nice to meet you, my name is Jung Sang-Min. I was a little surprised that many students do not know my name. It turned out that I forgot to introduce myself in the beginning of the class. I guess it's because I was too immersed in talking about the importance of history, especially Korean History. I believe that I'm a person who strives to make our country more beautiful, and the best way to do is to learn history.

MH: Did you have any specific motivations to choose to deeply delve into learning history?

Mr. Jung: I heard many people talking about how we should make the world better, but I've seldom heard anyone talking about why we should do that. I was curious, because I also didn't know the answer to this question. I still can't assure why certain things happen in our world, but as I delved into history deeper and deeper, I realized that history could be one way to offer me an answer.

MH: So you actually found Korean History very interesting and at the same time, very challenging. Unfortunately though, for many students at KMLA, history might seem to be a challenging and boring subject. How do you think about that?

Mr. Jung: That is a really good question. It's very sad that many students, especially Korean students, think of history as something tedious. I guess it's partly due to the fault of education. You know, most of the teachers teach history in the most boring manner. It is true that memorization is an important part of learning history. But it can be more fun and interesting if you learn the big picture first. For instance, when I teach maps, I try to introduce the continents first, and then individual nations, and lastly the cities. That way, names won't be jumbled in their heads.

MH: It seems that one of the heated controversies in the field of history in general is whether human history has been evolving, going into cycles, or retrogressing. What do you think about this issue, in accordance with Korean history?

Mr. Jung: Yes, it's true that historians have different views about the nature of history. But I try to be as optimistic as I could be. I believe that history does evolve as time passes. When you learn history, you will find out that there are some eras, periods, dynasties, or any other sort of chunks when certain society exists. Then, the next one comes, right? And this one emerges because the existing one has some kind of problem. The new society will fix this problem and make new rules, cultures, and traditions. Like this, the history has been a continuous improvement by preserving the good aspects of the past and correcting the bad ones. That's also why we all have to learn history.

Lee Hye-Joon
Junior Writer, 16th Wave

Interview with Ms. Hur Ka-Hyun

Minjok Herald: Can you briefly introduce yourself?

Ms. Hur Ka-Hyun: My name is Hur Ka-Hyun, and I came here as a new Chinese teacher. I'm very happy to be here studying with Korean Minjok Leadership Academy students. I majored and earned bachelor's degree in Chinese, and master's degree in Chinese education. My hobby is rock-climbing, which is a very thrilling, dangerous sport.

MH: We're just curious, but how did you come to teach in KMLA?

Ms. Hur: I've been doing my job, when I decided to take the teacher certification examination. Before coming to KMLA, I had been teaching employees of large corporations, such as Lotte, SK, Hyundae, Hynix, and others. Also, I had also given lectures in many universities. My high school career was once, when I taught students who majored in arts. I quit all my jobs and started preparing for the exam, when I got to know that KMLA was looking for a new Chinese teacher. Already, I have heard how famous KMLA was among other Korean high schools, and that made me eagerly apply right away. So, I'm delaying the exam for now, but it's okay.

MH: Well then, how was your first impression of KMLA?

Ms. Hur: My wish was to teach smart students. Usually, in universities, students do not try as hard as they did before. I had private lessons before, and it was enjoyable teaching. I felt that KMLA was a great place to teach eager, attentive students. Actually, I really bought the name of the school and had high expectations about the school students too. Oh, it doesn't mean that the expectations got lower (laughs). What surprised me was that the students were more polite than any other schools', and that they were passionate about learning itself. The students' such attentive attitudes also make the teacher prepare harder and be able to provide better lessons.

MH: Many students said that they like your class and students are curious about the style of teaching. Can you tell us about it?

Ms. Hur: Charisma? (laughs) Well, one thing I try to keep in mind is that Chinese as a liberal arts subject can be boring to most of the students. I believe that it is important for students to go through the initial hard, boring part. I try to help them endure it and be able to enjoy Chinese at last. Even if language skills seem poor at first, they are not earned in one step. Students should gradually increase their language skills. As a tip, I think it will be a positive influence to students if they have a foreign friend to share conversations with and have interest in the foreign cultures.

MH: Do you have anything to say last to the KMLA students?

Ms. Hur: My students once said that there is no opportunity to use Chinese in real life. Then, I see students trying to use English in school. Similarly, I hope that students will try and be able to use Chinese fluently as everyday language. If they need teacher's help in doing so, I will be very glad to help them.

Sung Yoo-Sun
Junior Writer, 16th Wave

Interview with Ms. Min So-Jeong

Minjok Herald: Can you briefly introduce yourself?

Ms. Min So-Jeong: Hi. My name is Min So-Jeong and I came to Korean Minjok Leadership Academy as a biology teacher this year. I majored in biology education and earned my master's degree in it. As I was preparing for my Ph.D program, I heard that KMLA was seeking for a short-time biology teacher. I became really interested and wanted to apply for the place. So, I took the interview with my friend. Then, I passed the interview, and this is my first time being a school teacher.

MH: So, this is your first time teaching. How was it?

Ms. Min: Well, I still feel very awkward and somewhat difficult in teaching yet. I'm not used to teaching high school students, and there are times I feel sorry for them. However, KMLA students have very sound attitudes and are passionate in the classroom, so it relieves me a lot. Also, they are nice to me and teaching such students is enjoyable. I believe that we will be able to get closer quickly.

MH: In school, teachers can share their hobbies with the students through extracurricular activities or sports. Do you have any hobbies to share with?

Ms. Min: My hobby is resting, actually sleeping (laughs). I also like to eat sweets and snacks. I don't like sports, but if chances are given, I would like to go field trip to science museums with my students. I hope it isn't too childish, though. A few days of field trip, where we can have various activities and science programs, would be awesome.

MH: Many students are interested in biology. Are there any tips for studying biology?

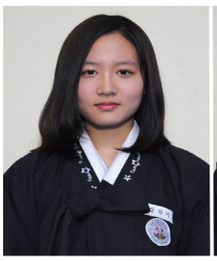
Ms. Min: Well, I believe some students are already better than me (laughs). For me, biology was least difficult among all science subjects. Basically, I was able to learn it without any pressure or worries. I think it is important to have as much as experience other than studying as possible. I wish students can joyfully learn what they want to learn while also enjoying what they want to enjoy. I feel sad that some students are under a huge stress, while there is no need to be so.

MH: Do you have anything else to say to KMLA?

Ms. Min: Well, when sitting in my office, I see several students passing by. I want to know them well, but students usually just give me a curious glance over the window. Instead of doing so, I hope they will bravely open the door and say hello to me. That way, we won't be shy anymore.

Sung Yoo-Sun
Junior Writer, 16th Wave

17th Wave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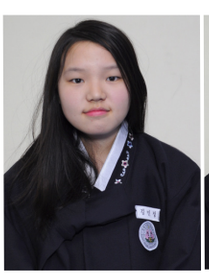
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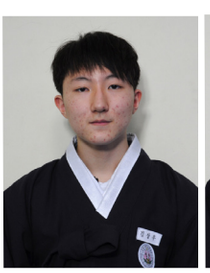
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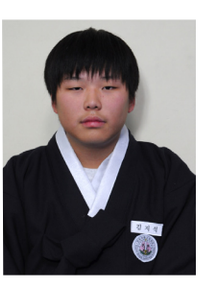
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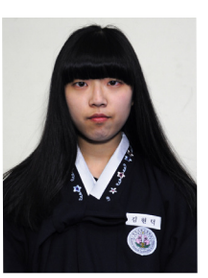
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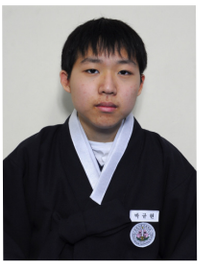
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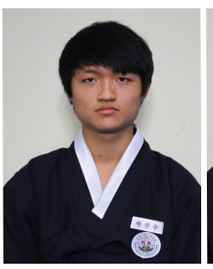
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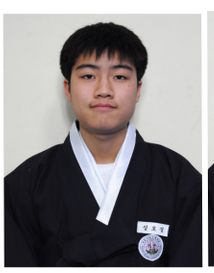
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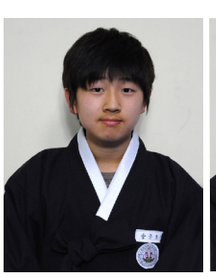
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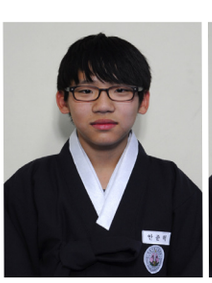
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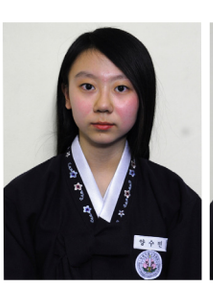
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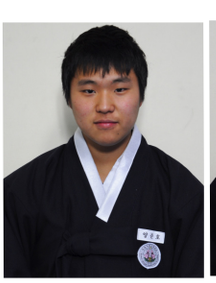
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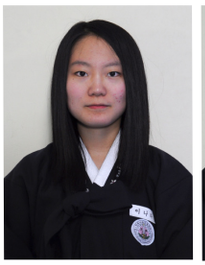
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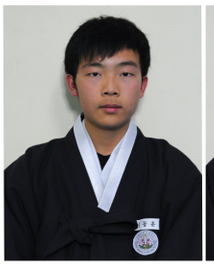
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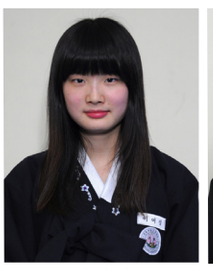
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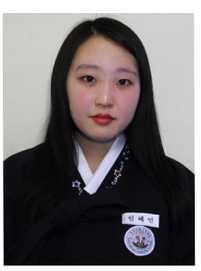
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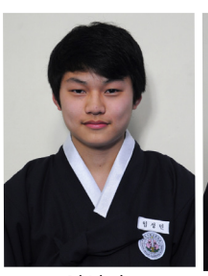
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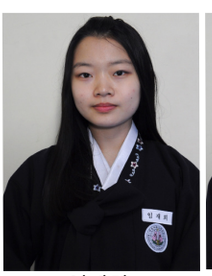
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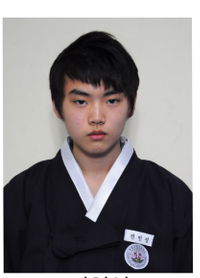
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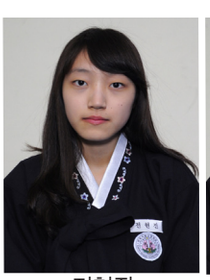
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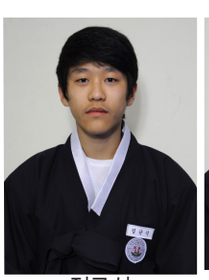
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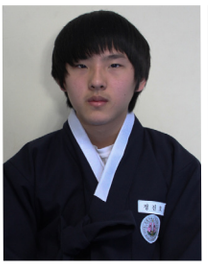
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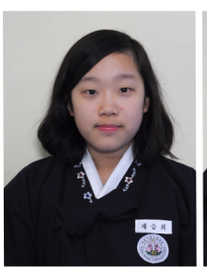
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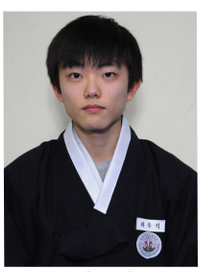
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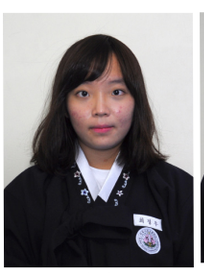
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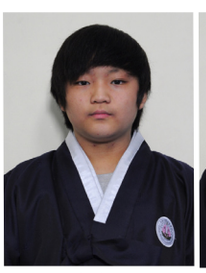
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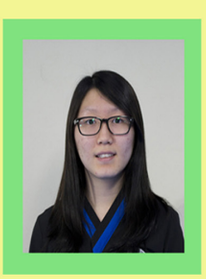

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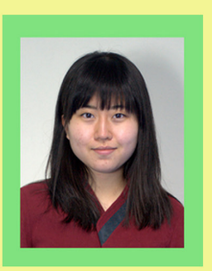

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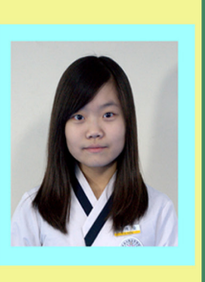
LEE EUN-JI

SUH DONG-IN



HWANG YE-SEUL